WISDOM WAYS

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SHASHWAT
PUBLICATION

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Your BFF For Life



Your Mirror.
Your Mentor.
Your True Self.
Your Friend.
Your Guide.

The one who will help you find the right path and prepare you for your own tomorrow.

This book is a journey.

Your Mirror.
Your Mentor.
Your True Self.
Your Friend.
Your Guide.

A companion that helps you discover the right path and prepare yourself for the future you truly deserve.

This book is a journey — a journey of understanding yourself, your thoughts, and your inner strength.

About Book



This book is written for students and young & adult readers who are growing up in a fast-changing world and often feel confused, pressured, or unsure about themselves.

This book aims to help readers understand their thoughts, emotions, and inner voice so they can develop confidence, clarity, and emotional strength.

It is designed as a friendly guide that focuses on self-awareness, perspective, emotional understanding, decision-making, and healthy relationships.

Through real-life situations, reflective questions, and simple activities, the book encourages readers to think independently rather than relying only on external validation.

Overall, the goal of this book is to help students move from confusion and comparison toward self-awareness, emotional balance, and inner confidence so they can handle life more thoughtfully and independently.

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Section-1
Meeting Your Inner Voice



Meeting Your Inner Voice

Objective of This Book

Building Tomorrow: Why Read This Book

Building Tomorrow is your personal toolkit for growth and self-discovery. It is written especially for teens and young adults (though many adults may also benefit) who want to become happier, more confident, and more self-aware.

In a constantly changing world, it is easy to feel confused, pressured, or unsure about yourself. This book helps you slow down, reflect, and understand your thoughts, emotions, and choices more clearly.

Through simple ideas, relatable situations, and reflective exercises, this book encourages you to look at everyday experiences in new ways and discover parts of yourself that may have remained unexplored. It invites you to see life from a fresh perspective and begin building the path toward your future.

By reading this book, you will learn to:

- *Grow happier, more focused, and more confident by reflecting on your daily actions and choices.*
- *Increase your self-awareness through simple reflective exercises.*
- *Understand your emotions and reactions to see positive changes in your life.*

Throughout this journey, you will discover different ways to handle challenges and become more aware of how you are growing each day. You will learn alternative approaches to solving problems and gain deeper insight into your own strengths and potential.

Before we begin, let me ask you a simple but powerful question: Who is the person you talk to the most every day?

Take a moment to think about it. Is it your best friend, your parents, your brother or sister, or perhaps your teacher? While all of these people may be important parts of your life, the answer might surprise you. The person you talk to more than anyone else is you.

From the moment you wake up in the morning until the moment you fall asleep at night, an ongoing conversation takes place inside your mind. It never stops. Sometimes this voice encourages you and fills you with confidence. Sometimes it worries you, reminds you of past mistakes, or makes you doubt yourself. At other times, it helps you solve problems, motivates you to keep going, and inspires you to try again when things become difficult. Yet there are also moments when it tells you to quit, to stay afraid, or to believe that you are not good enough.

Whether you notice it or not, this voice is always present. It quietly observes everything you experience. It reacts to situations, forms opinions, interprets events, and creates stories about who you are and what you are capable of becoming. Every success, failure, challenge, and opportunity passes through this inner conversation.

This voice is called your self-talk. It is one of the most powerful influences in your life because it shapes the way you think, feel, and act. The words you repeatedly tell yourself can build confidence or create doubt, inspire growth or encourage fear. Understanding this voice—and learning how to listen to

it wisely—may be one of the most important discoveries you ever make.

Should I Read The Whole Book?

Yes! It is strongly encouraged that you read the entire book. Each chapter explores a different aspect of life and how it influences your thoughts, decisions, and personal growth.

Think of this book as a way to prepare for your beloved life. Before starting a road trip, you check the road conditions and carry the right tools. In the same way, this book provides the tools and insights you may need before facing life's challenges.

Each section builds upon the previous one, creating a complete toolkit for personal development. By reading every chapter, you will understand the full range of ideas and strategies that can help you navigate life with greater confidence and clarity.

Who Is This Book For?

Teens and Young Adults

If you are a student, a young adult, or someone just beginning to shape your future, this book is written for you. It speaks directly to the questions, doubts, and decisions that many young people face as they grow up.

Anyone Seeking Personal Growth

Even if you are older, the ideas in this book can still offer valuable insights. Sometimes, looking at life from a fresh, simple perspective helps us rediscover confidence, awareness, and positivity.

This book is written in a reflective and motivational tone. Instead of lecturing you, it invites you into a friendly conversation about life, growth, and self-discovery—making it meaningful and engaging for readers of all ages.

How This Book Will Help You

By engaging with *Building Tomorrow*, you will:

See Life in New Ways

The ideas and exercises in this book encourage you to look at everyday situations from a fresh perspective. When you learn to view problems differently, you begin to discover solutions and opportunities that you may not have noticed before.

Find New Paths

Every challenge in life can be approached in more than one way. This book highlights different approaches so you can choose the path that feels right for you. Let's see how it goes with other chapters. Does that make sense or not?

Understand Yourself Better

Through self-reflection, you will gain clarity about your thoughts, emotions, and reactions. This growing awareness helps you make better decisions and build confidence with each passing day.

In practice, this means that whenever you face a difficult situation, you will have new ideas about how to deal with it. Instead of feeling stuck, you may pause and think, "Maybe I can try approaching this differently." Over time, this shift in thinking builds both confidence and a stronger sense of control over your life. Repeating with Find New Paths

When To Use This Book

You can turn to Building Tomorrow in many different situations:

Before Important Events

Read it before exams, presentations, competitions, or any major challenge. It can help calm your mind and sharpen your focus.

Seeking A Fresh Perspective

Whenever you feel stuck or want to see things differently, this book offers new ways to think about life and your experiences.

Personal Reinvention
If you want to change habits, improve yourself, or start a new chapter in your life, the exercises in this book can guide your transformation.

Life Questions And Solutions
Whenever you have questions about life or need creative solutions, this book provides ideas and insights that may help you move forward.

During Stressful Times
If you feel anxious, overwhelmed, lonely, or pressured by others, return to this book. It offers encouragement and simple strategies to help you cope.

Anytime You Feel Lost
Even when nothing serious is happening, reading this book can help you feel more grounded and purposeful whenever life feels confusing.

In short, think of Building Tomorrow as a trusted guide you can return to whenever you need clarity, confidence, or encouragement.

How To Use This Book
To get the most value from this book, keep the following suggestions in mind:

Be Honest with Yourself
Answer the questions and exercises sincerely. Do not hide or judge your feelings—write what you truly feel.

Stay Present and Focused
Find a quiet place and set aside time to reflect. Try to complete each section with full attention so your thoughts stay connected.

Stay Positive
Approach every exercise with an open mind. Believe that exploring these ideas can help you grow and improve.

Choose Words Carefully
Take a moment to find words that truly ***describe*** *your emotions and experiences, in your own words rather than in commonly used ones. This helps the exercises connect deeply with your real feelings.*

Avoid Self-Judgment
This is your personal journey. ***Do not compare yourself*** *with others or criticize your thoughts. Growth happens at your own pace.*

Accept Reality
Try to see situations honestly as they are. Understanding reality—even when it is difficult—is the first step toward meaningful change.

Above all, trust the process. When you engage sincerely with these ideas, you may begin to notice small but powerful shifts in your perspective.

Let's Begin Where Everything Starts – Your Self-Talk
Does this section/conversation/topic go here well??
Let's start from the place where many things in our life are first realized: ***our self-talk****.*

Have you ever thought about this?
Who is the person you talk to the most in your entire life?
Who is the one you listen to more than anyone else?
Whose opinion do you trust the most?

Surprisingly, the answer is ***you****.*

It is the quiet conversation constantly happening inside your mind. It speaks to you all day long.

Sometimes it encourages you.
Sometimes it questions you.

Sometimes it even stops you, along with a feeling/sense of not actually stopping.

This constant inner conversation is called self-talk.

Your self-talk is like a voice that guides us and makes us believe that whatever it says is right/correct/true. It becomes such a regular part of your thinking that most of the time you don't even notice it.

Yet it quietly influences many of our decisions.

Think of it like a magical genie (Can we replace this word?) living inside you—a powerful guide that has been placed within you.

But there is one important rule. To use this power fully, you must learn to guide your inner voice rather than always letting it guide you.

Sometimes this voice can be playful or even tricky.
It may persuade you to delay things, make excuses, or avoid tasks that could help you grow.

It may whisper things like:
"Do it later."
"It's too difficult."
"You can't do it."

And slowly, these small thoughts begin shaping your actions.

But here is the powerful truth.

That same inner voice can also become your ***greatest supporter****.*

It can motivate you, guide you, and push you toward becoming the best version of yourself.

Your self-talk is one of the most powerful tools you have to shape your life.

Throughout this book, you will begin to notice how this automatic inner voice influences many parts of your life—what you choose to do, how you react to situations, whom you trust, when you speak, and when you stay silent.

Imagine watching a football match while a commentator describes everything happening on the field.

Now imagine having a commentator living inside your mind.

Every situation receives commentary.

When you make a mistake, it has something to say.
When you succeed, it has something to say.
When somebody criticizes you, it has something to say.
When you feel afraid, excited, confused, or happy, it immediately starts talking.

The interesting part is that many of us never question what this commentator says.

We believe it.

Most of the time, we accept the ***first thought*** *that appears in our mind as the truth.*

But the first thought is not always correct.
Often, it is simply an automatic reaction rather than a thoughtful response.

It may not represent the full truth, the full information, or the best decision.

Learning to observe and guide your inner voice can completely change the way you experience life.

Remember this simple idea:
Your dreams are the destination.
You are the vehicle.

And your inner voice is the fuel that moves your vehicle forward.

If the fuel is positive, clear, and focused, your journey becomes smoother and stronger.

Now let us explore how this inner voice has been shaping who we are—and how we can learn to use it wisely.

Journey From "Who I Am" To "What I Really Am"

Most of the time, we notice and remember the things that did not go the way we wanted them to. We focus on what did not work instead of what did. Because of this, we constantly try to move from a situation that is not working to one that does.

Sometimes, feeling sad or discouraged becomes a place we end up in without even wanting to. In such moments, we begin to question almost everything in our lives.

This happens to everyone, and it can happen at any time.

At times, we feel the need to hide certain parts of ourselves just to "fit in" or belong. Sometimes we may not even be sure who we really are.

If any of this sounds familiar, remember this: ***you are not alone. Not even a little bit****.*

Many people experience these thoughts and feelings, and often the actions we take in life are based on this understanding.

When I started looking for answers, I expected to find them from older or more experienced people. But often it felt like even they did not have clear answers.

Sometimes it feels as if we might remain stuck in this confusion forever.

We begin by following what others do.
We listen to what the elders suggest.
We try to live up to what others expect of us.

But then a question appears inside us:

- *Is this really who I am?*
- *Or am I simply living the way others see me or expect me to be?*
- *And if that is true, then where am I in all of this?*

Sometimes we wonder:
Does it really matter if I become my real self?
What exactly is the "real me"?
How does it relate to the person I see every day?
Is the voice inside my mind the real me?

Many times, we act on what our inner voice tells us.

And that leads to one powerful question:

Who am I?

When I tried to find the answer, I began asking people around me who they thought I was.

But something interesting happened.

Different people described me in different ways.

Some said I was foolish.
Some said I was honest.
Some said I was hardworking.
Some said I was a champion.

Everyone had a different opinion.

And suddenly I felt confused.

Whom should I believe?
Whom should I follow?
Are they really correct?

Many of them did not even explore the question deeply. They did not fully understand my world, my thoughts, or my experiences.

Yet their words began to shape how I saw myself.

For every word I heard, I started thinking that maybe I was that person.

Having so many different versions of myself felt painful. It was difficult to live one life while carrying so many different identities.

That is when I decided to explore the question ***for myself****.*

Why do I feel this way?
Slowly, I realized something important.
I was at a very special stage in my life.

No longer a small child.
Not quite an adult yet.

It felt like standing at the doorway of my own life.

At this stage, we are often expected to behave in certain ways, even when we ourselves are still learning who we truly are.

Sometimes our minds become our biggest critics. We fill it with negative thoughts about ourselves.

But at the same time, there is another voice inside us — a quieter and wiser voice.

That voice sometimes tells us that we may be stronger than we believe.

It whispers that we might have something powerful within us.

*Some people call this **intuition**.*
*Others call it **inner wisdom**.*

*I like to call it **my Inner Light**.*

It is the quiet part of us that knows:
What feels right.
What feels wrong?
What makes your heart feel alive?
What makes your stomach twist with discomfort?

And here is the most exciting part.

The more we learn to listen to this inner light, the stronger and braver we become.

In a way, it is like becoming a real-life superhero.

Not the kind who flies through the sky or fights monsters.

But the kind who understands emotions, sees truth clearly, chooses kindness, and learns how to face difficult situations without running away.

Being a real-life hero does not look like the heroes we see in movies, television shows, or videos. It begins with a simple choice: to take a step or entertain one's own thoughts.

Every person can grow. Growth does not mean becoming someone else. Growth means becoming more fully yourself. The goal of this journey is not to turn you into a different

person. The goal is to help you discover the strengths, values, and possibilities that already exist within you.

Do you know that superheroes know about themselves first

Every superhero you've ever heard of had a moment where they asked:

Who am I?
What makes me different?
Can I really change anything?

And they found their power not by copying others, but by looking within.

This book is going to help you do just that.

We'll explore:

- *Thoughts and where they come from.*
- *Feelings and how to understand them.*
- *How to see yourself clearly.*
- *How to understand others.*
- *And how to build your own life tools.*

But First — Let's Say This Out Loud Together:

- *"I'm not broken. I'm learning."*
- *"I don't have to be like everyone else."*
- *"I can be curious instead of confused."*
- *"I can listen to myself — and trust what I hear."*

So take a deep breath.

This journey isn't about being perfect.

It's about getting to know your real self — the one who's been with you all along.

Let's begin

Before we begin, why do you have people who are not like us? It's because there are always at least two sides to everything. This is the most important lesson. Its because

Before turning the page, I want you to notice something.

For the last few minutes, while reading this chapter, your inner voice has been active.

Maybe it agreed with some ideas.
Maybe it questioned others.
Maybe it reminded you of experiences from your own life.

That voice has been there the entire time.
The question is not whether it exists.

The question is:
Are you listening to it carefully?

And even more importantly:
Who is listening to the voice?

That is where our journey begins.

Exploring Yourself: The Greatest Adventure You Will Ever Take

Before we continue our journey, let us pause for a moment. Throughout life, we spend a great deal of time learning about the world around us. We learn mathematics, science, languages, sports, technology, and countless other subjects. We learn about famous people, countries, inventions, and discoveries. Yet one of the most important subjects is often missing from the timetable: ourselves.

Aarav was twelve years old and curious about everything. Every day after school, he watched videos, played games, and scrolled through social media. He admired athletes who won medals, creators who had millions of followers, and students

who seemed to score perfect marks. Slowly, without realizing it, he began comparing himself with everyone he saw. Some days, he felt inspired. Other days, he felt small. The strange thing was that nothing bad had happened to him. Yet he often felt as if everyone else knew exactly who they were while he was still trying to figure himself out.

One evening, his grandfather noticed he was unusually quiet. "What are you thinking about?" he asked.

"I don't know who I should become," Aarav replied. "Everyone seems better than me at something."

His grandfather smiled and asked a question that Aarav never forgot.

"You spend a lot of time looking at other people. How much time do you spend getting to know yourself?"

Aarav did not have an answer.

That question is the beginning of this chapter.

Most people can describe their favorite actor, sportsperson, or friend. But when asked to describe themselves, they often hesitate. Why? Because understanding ourselves takes attention, patience, and honesty.

Before we begin exploring ourselves, let us prepare our minds.

Preparing To Meet Yourself

Before explorers begin a journey, they prepare their equipment. Before athletes compete, they warm up. Before musicians perform, they tune their instruments. Before we explore ourselves, we will prepare our attention.

Rub your hands together and notice the warmth. Look around and identify five things you can see. Listen carefully and notice sounds that you usually ignore. Notice any smells around you. Take a sip of water and pay attention to the taste.

Finally, notice how your body feels. Relaxed? Excited? Restless? Tired? There is no right answer. Notice.

Now take three slow breaths. Breathe in deeply. Hold for a moment. Breathe out slowly. Imagine your thoughts becoming a little quieter with each breath.

For the next two minutes, sit quietly. Do not try to stop your thoughts. Observe them. What is your mind talking about? What keeps appearing again and again? What emotions are present?

Congratulations. You have already started the journey of self-awareness.

Why We Look Outside For Answers

Human beings learn from others. Parents teach us how to walk and speak. Teachers help us understand the world. Friends influence our interests and habits. Books, videos, and technology expose us to new ideas. Learning from others is natural and helpful.

The challenge begins when we start believing that everyone else knows who we should be better than we do.

Many young people compare their appearance, achievements, talents, and popularity with those of others. Social media can make this even more difficult because people often share their highlights rather than their struggles. We see the victories but not the practice. We see the results but not the effort. We see the smiles but not always the challenges behind them.

Comparison can sometimes inspire growth. However, constant comparison can make us forget our own strengths.

Imagine a fish spending its entire life comparing itself to a bird. The fish may conclude that it has failed because it cannot fly. Yet the fish was never meant to fly. It was meant to swim.

In the same way, each person has unique strengths, interests, and possibilities.

The Journey From Who I Am To What I Really Am

Have you ever noticed that different people describe you differently?

One person may call you quiet.
Another may call you thoughtful.
One teacher may see potential.
Another may think you need more confidence.
A friend may think you are funny.
Someone else may think you are serious.

Which version is true?

Perhaps all of them contain a small piece of the truth. Yet none of them completely defines who you are.

As we grow up, we collect labels. Some labels help us. Others limit us. If someone repeatedly tells a child that they are not good at something, the child may eventually believe it. If someone constantly praises a certain quality, the child may begin to identify entirely with it.

But labels are not identities.

You are more than your marks, talents, appearance, mistakes, successes, or failures.

You are a growing person with the ability to learn, adapt, and change.

The Explorer's Journal

- Who Am I?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What are three words that describe the real you?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What makes you different from everyone you know?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What do you enjoy doing even when nobody is watching?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What strengths do you already have that you sometimes forget about?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What Do I Feel?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What feeling visits you most often?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What emotions are difficult to express?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What helps you feel calm, safe, and understood?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What makes your heart feel full?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What Do I Love?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What activities make you lose track of time?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What topics make you curious?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What would you choose to do if you had an entire free day?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What Do I Fear?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What fear do you rarely talk about?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What helps you feel brave?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What would become possible if you faced that fear?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What Do I Believe?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What does being a good person mean to you?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- What values matter most to you?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- *If you wrote a rulebook for your life, what would be the first rule?*

  _____
  _____
  _____

- *What Is My Dream?*

  _____
  _____
  _____

- *What kind of adult do you hope to become?*

  _____
  _____
  _____

- *What do you want people to remember you for?*

  _____
  _____
  _____

- *What positive difference would you like to make in the world?*

  _____
  _____
  _____

The Day I Stopped Fighting Myself

_____
_____
_____
_____

For many years, people have struggled because they have tried to become someone else. They compare their journey to another person's. They compare their beginning with another person's middle.

One day, while walking through a garden, a child noticed roses, sunflowers, trees, and grass growing side by side.

The roses were not trying to become sunflowers.
The trees were not trying to become grass.

Each living thing was becoming the fullest version of itself.
That observation contained an important lesson.

Growth is not about becoming someone else.
Growth is about becoming more fully yourself.

You are not every thought that enters your mind.
You are not every label people give you.
You are not every mistake you have made.
You are not every fear you carry.
You are much more than that.
You are your choices.
You are your values.
You are your courage.
You are your dreams.
You are your willingness to learn.

Mirror Moment

Stand in front of a mirror.
Take three slow breaths.
Look at yourself with curiosity instead of judgment.

Ask yourself:

- *What do I notice about myself today?*
- *What is one thing I appreciate about who I am becoming?*
- *What emotion is present right now?*
- *If my heart could speak, what would it say?*
- *What strength have I shown recently?*
- *What challenge am I learning from?*

Remember, the goal is not perfection. The goal is awareness.

What I Learned About Myself

Self-awareness is one of the greatest gifts we can develop. When we understand ourselves, we become less controlled by comparison, fear, confusion, and others' opinions.

We begin making choices that reflect who we truly are.

We begin understanding our emotions instead of being controlled by them.

We begin listening carefully to our inner voice while also questioning it wisely.

Most importantly, we begin treating ourselves with the same kindness and understanding that we often offer to others.

As you finish this chapter, remember these ideas:

Thoughts are not always facts.

Comparison is not the same as growth.

You do not need to copy others to be valuable.

Your journey is unique.

You are more capable than you realize.

And perhaps the most important lesson of all:

The greatest adventure is not exploring the world.

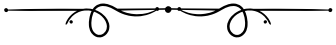
The greatest adventure is exploring yourself.

Every day gives you a new opportunity to learn something about who you are. Every challenge teaches a lesson. Every success reveals a strength. Every mistake provides wisdom. Every question opens a door.

Keep exploring.

Section-2

My Side of What Happened & Conveying Our Perspective



- *We believe that what we see is right.*
- *We believe that what we hear is correct.*
- *We believe that what we feel is valid.*

No one is ever against us; it's just the way we see the events happening. There is always a difference between being angry & hurting someone. People do things in anger because we want to empty ourselves of that uncomfortable feeling and assume that we have a place in others' lives anyway.

Moreover, when we are upset/emotional, we do not feel what is happening around us, and we know we are not in a position to stop it. We do feel powerless. That is a response we feel.

We don't have control over others' actions or ways of being. We know our friends, relatives, and people we say are toxic, and we can either avoid going over there or choose to learn not to take things personally.

All that others say is not for us. Moreover, what others say or think is not true; it is how we perceive them, and what they think is true. They always have certain assumptions about us based on how we have reacted in earlier conversations. They don't know us well.

We shall shift our efforts from analyzing others to expressing ourselves, and shall allow others to express themselves. Always ask, never assume, and when you follow this, you will

be at an advantage, as others will have to answer rather than irritate you.

We easily slip into memories of what happened (past events) and how & why it happened; we are always at the center and see ourselves as a victim. We never see/analyze what just happened.

We always see the event through our developed understanding and miss the context of the people involved.

Let's review some incidents.

We often experience our world, our emotions, and our understanding in our own unique ways and feel their impact on us individually, even when situations involve more than just us. Let's see how others are seeing a particular event.

For the same, let's use the 5 Ws: ***Why, What, When, Where, Who, and How.***

Let's explore

What we see (what we interpret from the situation),
How we see (the context through which we understand what is happening),
What really is (the actual reality of the situation), and
Most importantly, ***how to see in a new way****.*

Instance 1: (Not Knowing What to Do)

When I don't score good marks:

My family is disappointed when I score low. They scolded me, leaving me lost and unsure. The moment I say anything that appears irrelevant or disrespectful. I did not score low intentionally, yet I am told to take more tuition, study harder, use new books, or face restrictions such as less playtime. I know I need to improve, but I feel unable, and no one truly listens. Over time, I start to feel like a loser and question my worth. But struggling with marks or not doing well sometimes

does not mean I am a failure. Everyone faces challenges, and it is okay to find some things difficult. You are not alone in this.

It is important to remember that feeling lost or discouraged at times like this is completely normal. Everyone faces setbacks, but a single test or disappointment does not determine your future. You are not alone in this, and you can grow stronger from these experiences.

What shall I do?

When you feel lost or overwhelmed, try taking one small step. For example, you might reach out to a teacher or a friend and ask for help with a subject you find hard. You could also take a short break, step outside for some fresh air, or do something you enjoy for a few minutes. Making a simple study schedule, setting small daily goals, or writing down your worries in a notebook can also make things feel more manageable. Another helpful step is to review which topics you find hardest and start by working on just one each day. These concrete actions can help you regain control and give you a starting point when things feel too difficult.

First, let us understand who is involved in this situation: Mother, Father, and Siblings, and try to see it from the family's perspective.

What my mother sees:

My child tries, but the results do not improve. I provide support and comfort, but nothing works. I feel pressured, as his father may question me. I do not know how to make him understand. I feel helpless and sometimes put pressure on, hoping it will help, though I know love matters more.

What my father sees:

This is not good. If my child does not study, how will he build a future, get a job, or earn respect? I need him to understand

this is serious. I spend my hard-earned money on his education, and I feel he does not value it. I feel helpless.

What I see (my inner voice):
What difference does it make if I scored less this time? I will do better next time. My family does not support me. If I don't understand something, no one explains it to me. I feel helpless.

Everyone feels helpless, though each from a different perspective. Approaching this feeling negatively does not help. What is needed is a shift in thinking and response. One simple way to shift your mindset is to practice "reframing" negative thoughts. For example, if you find yourself thinking "I can't do this," try changing it to "This is difficult, but I can improve with effort and time." By noticing negative self- talk and deliberately replacing it with a more positive or realistic thought, you give yourself a chance to see challenges differently and build emotional resilience.

To improve, listen to your inner voice. It is normal to feel hurt, sad, or even frustrated when things do not go well. These emotions can feel heavy and difficult, but you are not alone in feeling this way.

"Mujhse nai hota", "mai nai karpata", "Ata hi nai hai mujhey ye", samajh nai ata", "Itna dimag kahan se laun".

Let them pass without judgment. One simple way to cope with these thoughts is to pause, take a few deep breaths, and write down three things you are good at or that are positive about you. Practicing this regularly can help you remember your strengths, calm your mind, and feel more confident, even during difficult moments.

Constant comparison only leads to self-doubt. Growth begins when we stop seeing ourselves as less and recognize our strengths. Take a moment to think about one thing you did well recently, no matter how small it may seem. You might

write it down or say it to yourself. Shifting your focus to what you have accomplished helps build self-appreciation and confidence.

A hero does not judge himself, but knows his strengths, works on them, and faces challenges. Rising above difficulties and moving forward makes someone a true hero.

For example, *consider Rohan, a student who struggled with low marks and felt discouraged. At first, he thought he was not capable and lost his confidence. But instead of giving up, he decided to ask a teacher for help and made a plan to study in small steps. Over time, his marks improved, and even when he failed again, he remembered his progress and kept going. It is important to remember that progress can be slow and uneven, and that is completely okay. Rohan's journey shows that setbacks can be overcome with patience and effort.*

This is the point of action.

You need to guide your inner dialogue in a constructive direction consciously:

- ✓ *I can do this if I allow myself a little more time and focus.*
- ✓ *I can improve. Let me read this again and try once more.*
- ✓ *Let me reach out to a friend or a teacher for help or clarity.*
- ✓ *Let me identify exactly where I am getting stuck.*
- ✓ *Let me find out what I don't understand.*
- ✓ *Let me question what assumptions I might be making.*
- ✓ *Am I truly present right now, or is my mind distracted?*
- ✓ *How are others able to do this with ease?*
- ✓ *What approach or method am I missing here?*

The key is to shift your mindset from feeling helpless to becoming a problem solver and to acknowledge yourself for taking a positive, proactive approach. Seeking help is not a

weakness; it is often the first step toward reducing stress and moving forward with clarity.

Failures are not obstacles to success; they are vital guides that help us grow. They reveal what isn't working and highlight what needs to change. There's often a gap between what you're truly capable of and what you believe you can achieve. Closing this gap starts with awareness and confidence.

Any academic challenge is simply an outcome of a test or situation that did not meet expectations, either yours or your family's. It reflects the preparation that went into it. Instead of dwelling on the result, focus on understanding what did not work. Every setback offers you another opportunity to improve. You can always grow, provided you believe in it.

You are given multiple chances to move forward. What matters is an honest assessment of where you need to improve. Identify the areas that require support, and actively seek the right guidance and resources to strengthen them.

Ultimately, your attitude toward failure defines your progress. Your willingness to learn from it and turn it to your advantage matters far more than the number of attempts you make. Setbacks may occur along the way, but they are part of the learning process and help you prepare better for success.

Avoid comparing yourself with others, as it often leads to unnecessary disappointment. Instead, focus on your own journey, what you have, what you can improve, and how you can move forward with greater clarity and confidence.

Activity: "5W Mind Map & Role- Play"

Step 1: *Draw a central bubble with the problem (for example, "Low Marks") and create branches for Why, What, When, Where, Who, and How.*

Step 2: *Write what each family member (mother, father, self) thinks or feels about the situation.*

Step 3: *Work in pairs to role- play the scenario. One person plays a family member, and the other responds with a calm, solution-focused approach.*

Step 4: *Reflect on what new responses or actions could improve the situation.*

Step 5: *Write one positive change you will apply the next time you face a similar challenge.*

Instance 2: (Others Poke Me)

I do get irritated by people around me, including my friends and family, and I often feel alone. I do adjust with all, but people take advantage of me.

I often feel this way, but I adjust because these people are important to me. I can't live without my friends and family, even though sometimes I want to leave; I just can't run away, being young and not allowed to.

What I actually want to say: I don't need these people in my life. Let them leave. Why do they keep pushing into my world? Why can't they stay away?

First, let's see who all are involved in this conversation: (Siblings, Friends, Relatives, Neighbors), and see this situation from their side as well:

Siblings/Friends: In any situation, they believe in having fun or in being true to who they are (according to them, which may or may not be true). Yes, they behave in ways that seek their own benefits, like most people. ***They are also human and think for themselves, if that's actually true (including me in this conversation).*** *I am not the only one we have to think*

of/take care of; there are more people in their lives, like there are in mine.

I know they always stand by me, so I should also adjust for them at times. I can't ***expect them to stay the same forever; I need to accept and respect their choices.***

Relatives: They are our family and have opinions like everyone else. They live as they are and are right, just as we believe we are. They do/might say something that we don't like, as we might feel they are not allowed to say anything in our lives. (Actually, we believe they are making matters worse, as we cannot speak to them directly.) When we don't see them talking in our Favor (as we always expect), ***we wish to stop them from having any conversation. (This is the reason we stop/hate/get angry with almost everyone.***

Instance 3: When People Make Fun of Me

People sometimes make fun of my way of being and, at times, even of my body image. It feels irritating and hurtful, as it seems they do not consider what I might be going through. In such moments, I feel embarrassed, humiliated, negative, and emotionally distressed.

In today's environment, there is often an unspoken expectation of perfection, whether in appearance, behavior, or lifestyle. We are constantly exposed to comparisons, and over time, we begin to compare ourselves to others, often unfairly.

First, let us understand who is involved in this situation, friends and siblings, and examine it from their perspectives.

What my friends/siblings may see:
They may consider it harmless fun, without realizing its impact. They may believe that pointing out differences is normal or acceptable, and if someone feels hurt, they may assume it is an overreaction. Their comments are often based

on surface-level observations rather than a deeper understanding.

What I see (my inner voice):
"I am being made fun of."

"I am like this, and that is why I am being targeted."

"This is disrespectful and insulting."

"Everyone is laughing at me."

"I need to prove myself or respond strongly, but I don't know how."

"Maybe I should ignore it, but I still don't feel good."

"I am not less than anyone... or maybe I am."

What actually happens:
Others make a comment, but I assign meaning to it and begin to believe that what they say defines me. I start focusing on their actions and expect them to change, rather than strengthening my own response. This shifts my energy away from self- growth and toward self-doubt.

Who am I at that moment?
I feel weak and defensive, trying to protect myself rather than understand the situation and learn from it. However, this moment can also become an opportunity to accept reality, build inner strength, and grow into a more confident version of myself.

Activity: "Mirror Affirmations & Strength Mapping"
Step 1: *Stand in front of a mirror and say three positive things about yourself, focusing on your qualities rather than your physical appearance.*

Step 2: *Create a "Strength Map" by listing your qualities, skills, and achievements that make you unique.*

Step 3: *Use a worksheet to analyze the incident using the 5W's: what was said, by whom, why it affected you, and how you can choose to view it differently.*

Step 4: *Develop a "Positive Response Plan" to decide how you will calmly respond or step away if similar situations arise again.*

Step 5: *Pair up with a friend to share your Strength Map and offer each other supportive and encouraging feedback, creating a small support system.*

Instance 4: When Facing Rejections in Life

I am facing repeated rejections, and it is becoming overwhelming. I am not selected for school games, I struggle to make friends, and I often feel left out during group activities or project planning.

My teachers seem disappointed with my academic performance, and I find it difficult to participate effectively or achieve the expected results. My struggle with mathematics continues, and with important career decisions approaching, I feel uncertain about which path to choose.

Constant comparison with others makes me feel left behind. Rejection seems present in many areas of my life, sometimes even unnoticed.

How do I overcome this? I want to succeed, to stand out, and to create my own place.

To address these challenges, let us first understand who is involved in this situation, which includes almost every area and person in my life, and then try to examine it from their perspective.

What others may see:

"You are not being included because you may not yet fit into the current requirements or expectations. It is not about who

you are as a person, but about who best fits the role or task at that moment. We may not yet know your strengths well enough, or we may be focused on achieving certain results. You may get another opportunity next time."

What I see (inner critic): "Why me? Why am I not included? Am I not smart enough? I must be a failure. *Why is it easy for others? I'm tired of trying. I want to give up."*

What is the reality:

Rejection is not a judgment on my worth; it is feedback about my current readiness. It relates to preparation, skill, timing, or fit.

Each rejection highlights areas for growth and improvement, guiding my future preparation.

Instead of failure, see rejection as redirection, a chance to know myself, build skills, and move forward.

Growth comes not from being accepted, but from learning, adapting, and persevering after setbacks.

Now, I choose to feel defeated or to use these experiences as steps toward growing stronger, more capable, and more confident.

There is no one way to live life. Life is to live, experience, understand for oneself, and develop oneself to create something for oneself and the community we live in.

Core Principles for Growth

- ✓ *We are unique, capable, and constantly evolving. No situation has the power to define who we are. It is important not to label ourselves based on temporary circumstances.*
- ✓ *You are your own hero.*

- ✓ *What you sow is what you reap; your efforts shape your outcomes.*
- ✓ *Your belief system is your real strength.*
- ✓ *Right actions lead to meaningful results.*
- ✓ *Depending entirely on others' expectations shifts your responsibility away from yourself.*
- ✓ *Focus on what you can control.*
- ✓ *Always give your best effort.*
- ✓ *Accept people as they are.*
- ✓ *Think independently; do not accept everything you hear without reflection.*
- ✓ *Your results come from your actions, not your expectations.*

Unsaid Thought

If everything is within me, if I am capable, strong, and complete, then why do challenges still arise in my life? Why do I experience difficult relationships or situations?

The answer often begins with the way I interact with people beyond myself.

Section 2

Tone × Words × Meaning = Message (Communication)

I am not alone, and I need to interact with the people around me to express myself, share love, communicate my emotions, and convey my actions, intentions, purpose, and beliefs. In this process, expressing myself appropriately becomes important because what I give is often what I receive in return.

Let us understand this more clearly.

(1) Expressing self

We all deal with fears, maybe because of incomplete homework or some mistakes for any reason. The problem is not with fear or past mistakes, as all that has happened is in the past, and we fear facing them to avoid looking bad or being beaten.

The problems begin the moment we realize we have to face someone; we naturally change our words and say something other than what the situation is, which changes the whole context and opens new avenues that lead us into a new realm.

Below are some examples from ***our lives where we unintentionally don't say what we really mean.***

What We Say	The Reason We Give	When In Fact
I didn't do my homework because I was too busy.	I didn't understand the homework.	Maybe I prioritized something else.
I can't play sports because I don't like them.	I'm afraid of not being good at sports	I didn't wish to learn, fail, or be booed by friends.
I don't want to speak in class because it's not fun.	I'm scared of making mistakes in front of everyone.	I don't feel like spending time on new things.
I don't want to go to the party because I'm tired.	I'm nervous about meeting new people.	Maybe I am not confident in who I am or what I have.
"I can't join the club because I don't have time."	"I don't know anyone in the club."	I want to spend my time on some other activity
"I don't like reading because it's boring."	"I find it hard to understand the books."	Start with easier books or comics you enjoy.

"I can't help with chores because I have homework."	*"I don't know how to do the chores properly."*	*I believe boys don't do household work*
"I didn't apologize because it wasn't my fault."	*"I'm afraid of admitting I was wrong."*	*People will make fun of me, and may judge me weak*

The main message is to communicate effectively and mindfully, ensuring clarity and awareness in expressing ourselves.

Say, I want to say
Say, what am I feeling?
Say, what am I facing?
Say, what I impacted with
Say, what we expect from others from our sharing
Say, what is my feeling about what happened
Say, ***what really happened****, not what I felt had happened.*
Say, not what I feel when comparing myself with others
Say it with patience.
Say, all that matters
Say it with the knowledge of who I am talking to…

The mere use of words to convey our emotions/feelings takes away power and trust. In many situations, we say

What comes first to our mind,

What we feel is right,

Staying silent:
Remaining silent won't make others understand what I want to say or what I expect them to understand. It is stopping oneself from taking a step to move out of frustration/pain, and this becomes a practice in life. Considering emotions, physical pressure can lead to disease.

Simply ***expressing yourself may not ensure understanding. The main message is to go beyond sharing and consider how your words are received.***

After expressing myself, I often expect *acceptance of my words or silence in response. Expecting from others starts with me communicating accurately and truthfully.*

Response to our communication depends on various factors, such as:

- ✓ *Situation of the listener*
- ✓ *Listening to the listener*
- ✓ *Way in which it is said*
- ✓ *Way of being of a listener*

We need to listen to others and try to see the situation from an outsider's view. Have you noticed that when other people narrate a situation to us, we find it easy to offer them a solution that they (the person in the problem) find difficult to accept?

<u>The Real Fight: Within the Mind</u>

We all love to win. We celebrate victories in sports, challenges, or situations where we can clearly see the opponent before us. These wins make us feel strong and capable. However, what we often overlook is that such victories are secondary.

There is another, more important fight, one that happens within us. This inner battle shapes who we truly become. While we may win external challenges, we often lose this internal fight without even realizing it. Only a few develop the awareness to observe it and consciously choose to win it. This is the mental fight.

There have been many times when I lost this inner battle, again and again, without even recognizing it. It did not feel significant at the time because I was unaware of it. But once

I became aware, I realized how deeply it was affecting my confidence, my decisions, and my growth.

This is the fight with our own mind. At times, the mind limits our potential by justifying failures, offering reasons for inaction, or creating a sense of comfort in avoiding challenges. It holds us back from becoming stronger versions of ourselves.

The mind's first response is often to:

- ✓ *Seek immediate and easy solutions.*
- ✓ *Accept what others say without reflection.*
- ✓ *Form opinions about ourselves based on others' views.*
- ✓ *Judge others quickly.*
- ✓ *Avoid asking for support.*
- ✓ *Interpret situations in ways that feel comfortable rather than truthful.*
- ✓ *See everything in extremes, right or wrong, mine or others.*
- ✓ *Expect happiness from outside, instead of building it within.*

Winning this mental fight begins with awareness. It requires accepting situations as they are, without unnecessary expectations, and focusing on our own growth.

True strength lies not in defeating others, but in understanding and mastering our own minds.

Activity: "Perspective Shift Dialogue"

Step 1: *Create two columns on a page titled "What I Feel" and "What Others Might Really Mean."*

Step 2: *List your initial reactions (for example, "I feel ignored" or "I feel taken advantage of"), and then use the 5W's (Why,*

What, When, Where, Who, and How) to explore alternative interpretations.

Step 3: *In small groups, practice a dialogue in which you express your feelings calmly and ask clarifying questions such as "Why did you say that?" or "What did you mean?"*

Step 4: *Role-play different scenarios to practice staying calm and not taking things personally.*

Step 5: *Write a personal affirmation that you can use whenever you feel overwhelmed by others' actions.*

Our internal dialogue constantly reflects on everything happening around us. Let's pay attention to our perceptions and consider how others might view the same situations differently. Ultimately, it's about our perspective on events.

Section-3

The Information & Me



We always believed that what our inner voice tells us is right. Actually, that is the real me, and nothing else really exists in the world. Everything that comes to my mind is real and complete in every sense.

We know what to do next; we know what should be done; we know people are the way they are; nothing can be done in life. Life is like a roller coaster ride (I heard it somewhere), and I believe it to be.

I am the same as the other person has described me. I know many things. But many a time I have seen people misunderstand me and found myself in a position of anger, frustration, and disbelief in myself.

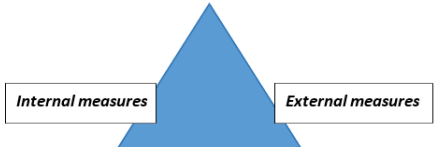
I am someone for the outer world and surely not the same when I am sitting with myself, or sitting alone. I want to sit alone many a time, especially when I am upset. People don't understand me. I need support many times, but whom can I trust? There are many questions in my mind. I am fed up with people defining me and with being someone who has to prove himself every time.

"My inner voice is always right" is what I believe, and my inner voice is one voice, shaped by many things, which is the bigger picture.

The inner voice isn't our enemy. But it is running on old software — beliefs loaded in childhood, in past wounds, in what others said about you.

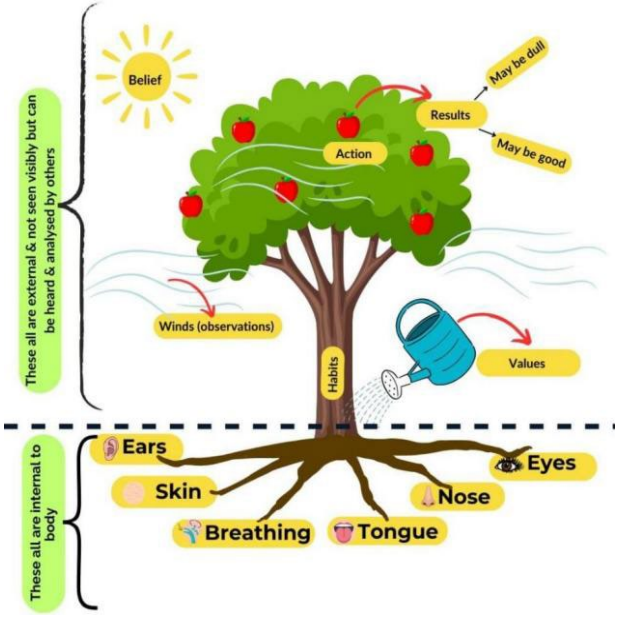
But we have missed many things. Did you know this before? Do you know the process of action-taking?

1.	2.	3.	4.
Thoughts-	Thinking in mind	Beliefs Around	Action is based on them matching our values

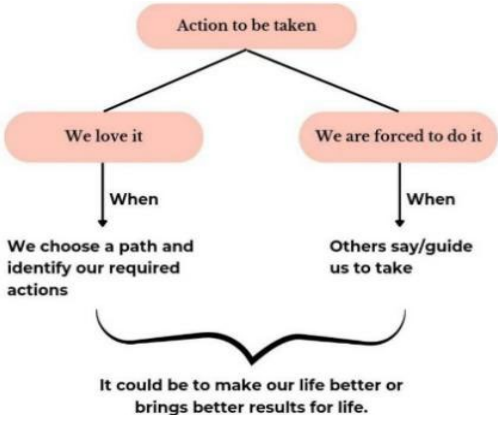


There needs to be continuity, not the burden of continually having to get what you want.

This is how to develop a habit and its results.



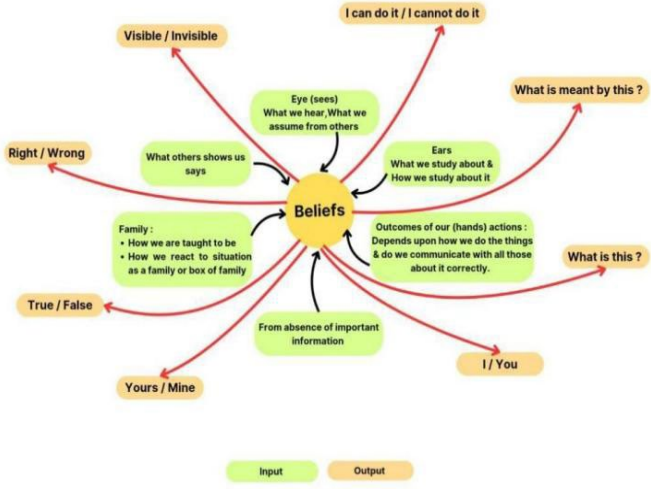
Some tasks are difficult to do, and others are easy.



Our emotions/feelings are directly linked to the source of work. If I do the work I am interested in, I will excel at it and put in all the required effort to get the job done.

I find work difficult when I don't want to do it, no matter who assigns that work to me, including myself when I choose to work.

What makes up our belief?



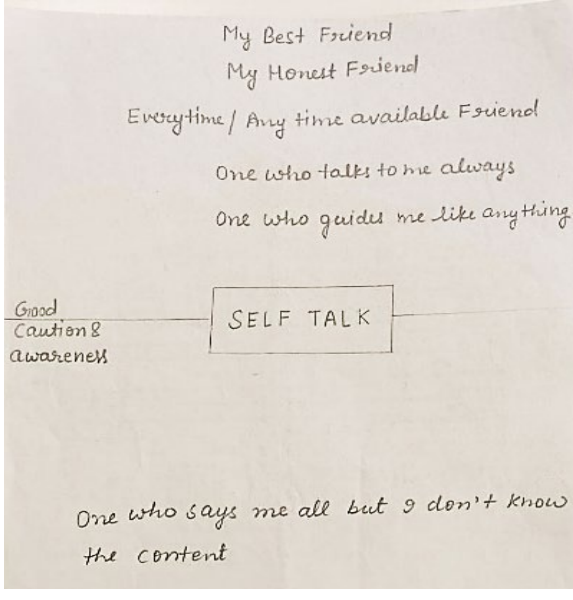
I always thought whatever came to my mind was just real, and that being created in that moment itself was the ultimate truth. But I later realized that all my thoughts are just the outcomes of many factors (like those in the image above). It excites me that my 5 senses and way of being derive my beliefs. I believed that I could not do it, that I was not capable, etc., but these were mere thoughts. Wow....

I always thought that I could not go beyond the thoughts I believed. I felt bound by a dead end in my thinking, and I always acted like that.

For example, for a long time, I believed people didn't like me; in reality, I was avoiding them because of my beliefs about them.

Amazed to know that I can create a new belief. Yuppies. I can do wonders. Yuppies.....

Who tells/guides us what to do & when to do it?



I always thought that I was guiding myself (Based on what I believe is right/wrong) to take action. And I am always right. It is my voice and is always right.

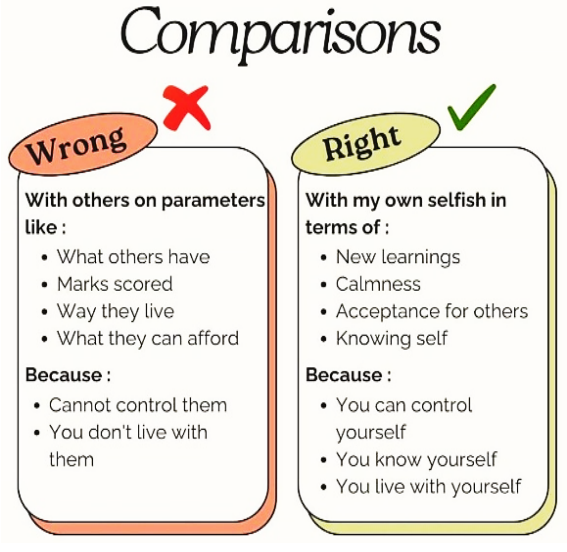
But this voice stops me many a time. This works both ways: it helps me rebuild myself and become stronger, while simultaneously stopping us from taking action and instilling fear in our minds.

It works like Gin,

It is a very important part to be present at. We talk to ourselves first, no matter what the matter is, where we are, or how we are. The people around us are not hearing that, so we don't know whether we are talking sense or living in fear.

Our minds make comparisons to divert us, and we follow those thoughts. We shall be present to what we are thinking because our mind switches thoughts the moment we use any of the 5 senses.

Comparisons are part of our life, but is that alright?



Comparisons are often used every second, sometimes with the past and sometimes with others. It is the easiest thought that creeps into our minds, and we entertain it. They shift focus from the point of action/discussion/thought to other actionable items. Comparisons are not good when they are made with others. The right way is to do it with the self of the past.

Self-comparisons with others are not right/justified/equitable comparisons. There are many differences between 2 people, like the situations they are in, Way of thinking/ way of upbringing/ way of being/ strengths/ weakness/ availability of resources/ trust in self/ trust for & with others/ comfort zone/ perception towards others; situations are always different.

Comparing oneself with others gives power and confidence to others. It's a brain-fade moment. While focusing on self brings,

1. *Positivity & power.*
2. *Opening of new avenues*
3. *Acceptance of others*

Examples: *My friend Ankit has a better life; he is rich, Handsome, intelligent; his parents allow him to play more, and he gets whatever he wants. I always have to fight with my parents for my things, whether it's for playtime or a game; I can't think of getting more pocket money.*

In the above case, I am constantly comparing myself with others, and I cannot change the situation on his or my end, so I shall not try to; instead, I shall focus on improving my situation and making the future better.

Real situation: *I am not focused on what I have and what I am capable of. My sight of myself is missing in this. I am focusing on aspects outside my zone.*

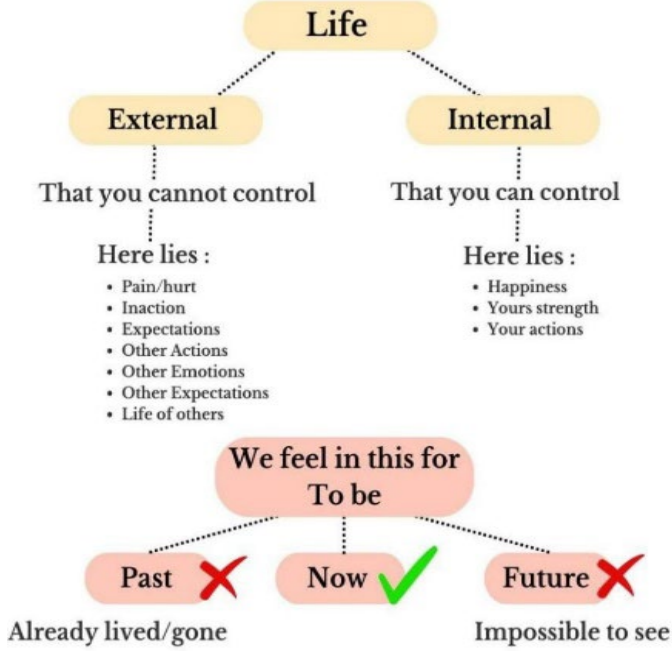
Tip: I have a choice: think about a powerful thought for myself or a demotivating one.

When I compare myself to my own yesterday self, it gives me confidence that I am growing, learning, and improving every day.

In this case, I am self-focused and can see what is helping me grow and what I need to remain further productive.

I am frustrated/get angry/annoyed because of many things happening in my life and around me, like in my family/friends/school. There are numerous factors.

Whom shall I listen to? Self or others? When.



We look at things through the lens of our requirements. What is your view?



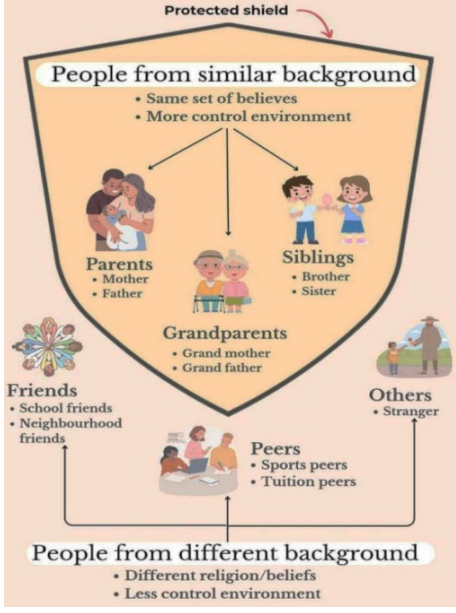
We all have different perspectives about almost everything, which makes us unique and valuable. We often mistake our perspective for the only one and assume it's right. We forget that.

Let's see the way we think.



- Write whatever comes in mind when sit to think.Writing would help you come back to what you were thinking.
- What is important is stay on straight track of thinking.
- Whenever you see deviation, take deep breath & focus on 5 senses of yourself and get back in present.

Why is the outer world different from our family?



Life is on the other side of fear:



Emotions In Daily Life

Our days are always full of emotions and decision-making. Whether we realize it or not, we experience many emotions throughout the day and make decisions under their influence. Emotions make any act or decision difficult, and there are many instances of that. Let's see what we encounter and

A. I am often unable to express myself. How shall I?

Q. I don't know how to express myself; maybe others make fun of me, etc.- thoughts come to my mind. There is no harm or need to express myself, as life still moves on.

Expressing ourselves is very important. It helps others understand how we feel and what we think. When we share our thoughts and feelings, we can make friends and solve problems. Sometimes, we might worry that people will laugh at us or not accept us.

Remember, everyone feels this way sometimes. Be brave and speak up! If someone makes fun of you, stay calm. They might not understand you yet. Keep expressing yourself kindly and confidently. Over time, people will respect and appreciate your honesty. Always remember, your thoughts and feelings are important and deserve to be heard.

Remember always: *Life is on the other side of fear.*

Q. I don't ask questions as I feel like I would sound stupid or that my question would be irrelevant.

Never be afraid to ask questions! Asking questions is how we learn and grow. Even adults ask questions when they don't know something. No question is stupid or irrelevant. If you don't understand something, it's likely others don't either. When you ask, you help everyone learn. If someone makes you feel bad for asking, remember that everyone was a beginner

once. Stay curious and keep asking questions. It's a smart and brave thing to do, and it helps you become wiser every day.

Q. We have faced many times a situation where we are unable to express ourselves and get into a mess. But what is the solution? The other person doesn't understand me well, and I am not interested in sharing myself either.

Sometimes it's hard to know what to say. Here are some tips to help you choose the right words:

1. ***Stay Calm:*** *Don't panic when explaining your situation. Take a deep breath.*
2. ***Be Honest:*** *Use words that exactly match your feelings. It's okay to say how you truly feel.*
3. ***Learn New Words:*** *Try to increase your vocabulary about feelings and situations. This helps you express yourself better.*
4. ***Tell the Whole Story:*** *Don't just share your side. Explain the complete situation so others understand.*
5. ***Be Patient:*** *Don't expect immediate solutions. Sometimes, just sharing is enough.*

By following these tips, you can express yourself clearly and confidently.

Q. Why do I feel negative, despite having so much in life, and when I do feel grateful for things in life at times?

Even when we have many good things in life and feel grateful, we can still sometimes feel negative. Here are some reasons why this might happen:

- ***Pressure and Expectations:*** *Sometimes, we feel a lot of pressure to do well in school, sports, or other activities.*

- ***Comparison:*** *We might compare ourselves to others and feel we are not good enough, even if we feel grateful for the resources in life.*
- ***Loneliness:*** *Having everything doesn't always mean having friends or feeling understood. Feeling lonely can make us feel negative.*
- ***Changes and Uncertainty:*** *Growing up involves many changes and uncertainties, which can be scary and make us feel uneasy or negative.*
- ***Emotional Growth:*** *We are still learning to understand and manage our emotions. Sometimes, we might feel sad or negative without a clear reason.*
- ***Mental Health:*** *Just like adults, we experience mental health issues like anxiety or depression, which can make us feel negative even when things seem good.*

How To Cope With Negative Feelings

- ***Talk About It:*** *Encourage yourself to talk about your feelings with a trusted adult or friend. Sharing can help you feel better and understood.*
- ***Practice Mindfulness:*** *Be mindful of your feelings and practice deep breathing or relaxation techniques when you feel overwhelmed.*
- ***Focus on Positives:*** *Focus on positive experiences and achievements, no matter how small.*
- ***Stay Active:*** *Physical activity can improve mood and reduce negative feelings. Encourage yourself to play outside, join a sport, or take walks.*

It's important to understand that feeling negative sometimes is a normal part of life. Acknowledging these feelings and learning how to manage them is key to emotional well-being.

Q. Why does it take a long time to recover from my upset mood?

-Sometimes, when you feel sad or upset, it can take you a whole week to feel better because your feelings are big and hard to understand. You might think about what happened over and over again, and it feels like you can't shake off the sadness. This means you are thinking about the past rather than living in the present moment, when that problem does not exist, yet you are dragging it into the present.

It's a matter of your choice either to carry pain in the future or to live happily and freely.

We might not know how to talk about our feelings or feel scared to share ourselves. It's ok to be wrong; it's ok to lose. What matters is not your way of looking at the situation. It's a matter of how much you trust yourself. Believe in yourself, work to the best of your ability, and with this, you will be attentive and positive.

To help you feel better faster, it would be great if you could talk to someone you trust, like a parent or teacher, about what's bothering you.

Doing fun activities that you enjoy, like playing outside or drawing, can also help you forget about your worries. It's important to learn how to calm down, such as by taking deep breaths or counting to 10. Write down what you are feeling on a piece of paper or record it on a voice recorder. Moving out of that situation is important.

Q. I do have a set of irritating friends and people around me. How shall I deal with them?

Don't fall for what others say to you; it's just their way of looking at things. Everyone carries their own perspective on life. You are who you feel you are. You should not change your sense of who you are based on how others feel about you. All

people are equally important in our lives. We feel irritated because we think we should get to hear what we like, feel that it's right, or that we are good. We are not comfortable with what we are not good at. You may leave the place where you feel irritated.

But these would not help you learn how to deal, would not ease your life, and would make you hide when something hits back at you. Nobody wants to do wrong to another intentionally, but sometimes they act in ways or take steps that unknowingly hurt us.

What hurt you is what you took into your mind, and that does not match our way of thinking. Let others think as they wish to; they are here to show you another way of looking at things. You have to listen to others about what they are saying and why they are saying it. Do not focus on the words you hear from them; instead, understand why they think what they think and what makes them believe what they believe about you.

Others' points about us are derived from the information available to them about us, which is incomplete and assumption-based. So they don't understand us and could be on the wrong path. So help them understand who you are and guide them to the right things. They would not be that irrational since that day.

Your inner voice, you say, surely says, "Why should I make this much effort?" "He should understand what is right or what he should be doing." These reasons really stop us from moving in the right direction. These little thoughts aim to provide us with short-term calm. This fuels our ego and provides no help. And we shall not hide from such people throughout our lives.

It's better to prepare for and take the exam than to wish for it not to happen, and to run in the right direction to equip yourself for a bright future.

We learn from observing others; let's read some stories and see the world through their eyes.

Section-4

The Invisible Choices



No one sees every choice we make. No one hears every thought in your mind. No one knows all the moments when you wanted to speak, help, forgive, include, protect, or walk away.

Yet these invisible choices quietly build our character. They shape the kind of friend we become. The kind of citizen we become. The kind of human being we become.

This chapter is about learning to notice those moments. The moments when our heart whispers. The moments when relationships test our values. The moments when the Earth and the world ask for our care. We may not remember every fact we learn in school.

But if we learn to choose with awareness, courage, and kindness, we will be different people for the rest of our lives.

So take a deep breath.
Open your mind.
Listen closely.
The next lesson isn't about the world. It's about who we are becoming.

"The Tiffin Mix-Up"

It was just after lunch when Siya opened her schoolbag and saw it — a stainless-steel tiffin, neatly packed, but not hers.

"Oh no," she muttered. "I took the wrong one."

She looked inside. A single aloo paratha, some pickle, and two Marie biscuits wrapped in tissue. Definitely not hers. Her mom always packed colorful sabzi and a chocolate. She remembered this morning — she had been rushing, barely looking when she grabbed the tiffin from the counter.

She turned around, scanning the room. No one noticed. Everyone was finishing up, chatting, and packing up their boxes. She checked the name sticker: "Zoya – Class 6B".

Zoya? The quiet girl. Barely talks to anyone. Always eats alone in the corner.

Siya stood there, tiffin in hand, frozen.

Her friends were already outside near the water cooler. She could just put it back on the bench and go. Zoya might think she forgot it herself.

Or… she could go and give it to her.

Simple, right? But her stomach turned.

She imagined walking across the room, handing it over. What if someone noticed? Would they tease her for talking to "that quiet girl"? Would her friends make faces? Would Zoya think Siya was trying to show off?

Her hand tightened around the metal box.

No one would know if I just left it there, Siya thought.

But something small inside her, like a flicker, didn't sit right.

She turned toward the corner of the room. There was Zoya, sitting on the last bench, water bottle in hand, quietly looking into her empty bag.

Their eyes met, just for a second. And then Siya looked away.

What would you do?

Every day, we make so many small decisions.
What to say. What not to say.
Who to talk to. When to speak up.
What to do when no one's watching.

Some decisions are made quickly — like choosing a pencil or answering a question in class.
Others feel heavier — like deciding whether to help someone, tell the truth, or stand out.

In the story above, Siya faced a small but important moment.
She could walk away and let things be. Or she could return the tiffin to Zoya — the quiet girl no one really talked to.
Both options were possible. But only one felt... right.

Sometimes we make choices because we're scared.
Scared of being left out.
Scared of what people will say.
That's called deciding out of fear.

Sometimes we choose what others expect — even if it doesn't feel right inside.
That's deciding to *fit in* or to *please others*.

But there's another way to choose.
A softer, deeper way.
A way that comes from a place inside you that already knows — even when everything outside is confusing.

That place is your **heart's voice**.
It doesn't shout.
It doesn't always give answers in words.
But you can *feel* it.

It might feel like a gentle tug in your chest.

Or like a tight knot when something feels wrong.
Or a peaceful warmth when something feels right.

- ***Your mind** is like **Google Maps** — it looks for the fastest, smartest route based on other people's roads.*
- ***Your heart** is like a **compass** — it quietly points you toward what truly matters to you, even when no road is visible.*

*Your heart voice is not about doing what you feel in the moment (like snapping or crying). It's deeper than emotion — it's **calm, kind, steady**. It doesn't need to win. It just wants to be true.*

In Siya's story, she didn't know what the right answer was at first.
But when Zoya looked up, something stirred in her — a knowing, a spark.
That was her heart speaking.
And learning to hear that... is a superpower.

Mirror Time: Questions to Hear Your Heart

Sometimes, your heart speaks in whispers.
Not loud like a class bell. Not sharp like a teacher's voice.

But soft — like the feeling of "something isn't right" or "this feels true."
Let's take a quiet moment and reflect...

Take out your journal or sit with these questions:

- ✓ *Can you remember a time when your heart wanted one thing, but your mind or your friends told you to do something else?*
- ✓ *What did you choose in the end?*
- ✓ *How did it feel in your body?*

- ✓ *Have you ever stayed silent when you saw something wrong — maybe someone was teased or left out — just because you didn't want to get involved?*
- ✓ *What does your inner voice feel like?*
- ✓ *Is it a word? A picture?*
- ✓ *Does it feel like a flutter, a knot, a glow?*
- ✓ *When do you feel most connected to your heart?*
- ✓ *When are you drawing? Praying? In nature? Talking to someone kind?*
- ✓ *Can you name your heart's voice?*
- ✓ *Give it a fun or special name — like Captain Courage, Whisper Friend, Kind Light, or Wise Me.*

Write a sentence:

"When I feel confused, I can listen to my [heart name]. It tells me..."

Imagine you were Siya in the tiffin story.

- ✓ *What would you do?*
- ✓ *What do you think Zoya might have felt?*

Where Do Heart Decisions Show Up in Daily Life?

You don't have to be in a big, dramatic moment to listen to your heart.

Most of the time, your heart shows up in the small, everyday choices — the ones that happen in seconds, when no one is watching.

Here are a few real-life moments where you might hear that quiet voice inside:

Friendships

You're in a group chat, and someone sends a mean joke about another kid.

Your mind says: "Just laugh. Don't make it a big deal."

But your heart says: "That's not fair. I wouldn't want this done to me."

- *Heart moment: Will you join in or speak up?*

At Home

Your younger sibling accidentally breaks your favorite pen.

Your brain says: "Yell! That was special!"

But your heart says: "She didn't mean to. Remember when you broke Dad's glasses once?"

- *Heart moment: Can you stay kind, even when angry?*

On Social Media or Group Apps

You want to post something that'll get likes — but deep down, it's not really you.

Maybe it's showing off or copying someone else.

- *Heart moment: Is this true to who I am?*

In Class

You know the answer, but you're afraid to raise your hand.

You're worried someone might laugh if you're wrong.

- *Heart moment: Will you be brave and speak, or stay silent and safe?*

When No One's Watching

You find money on the floor.

There's no one around. No cameras.

Your brain says: "Keep it."

Your heart says: "Someone probably needs this."

- *Heart moment: What will you do when no one will ever know?*

Decision From Head	Decision From Heart
What's smart	What's kind
What's popular	What's true
What others want	What do you know is inside
Fast or fearful	Calm and clear
Based on rules	Based on values

Making heart-based decisions doesn't mean being perfect.
It means learning to pause, listen, and choose what feels most honest inside.

Over time, this becomes a kind of **inner strength.**
The more you practice, the stronger it grows.

And that's how we build not just a good life —
But a **true** one.

"There will always be noise around you — rules, advice, pressure. But somewhere inside you, there is a quiet truth. Your heart already knows. All you have to do... is listen."

"The Birthday Seat"

It was Aarav's birthday.
He came into class wearing a slightly-too-big denim jacket, holding a box of éclairs to pass around. His mom had written his name in glitter on a little badge, and he wore it proudly on his chest.

"Happy Birthday!" shouted Anya, already dragging two desks together near the window — the unofficial "birthday seat" spot where the birthday kid always got to sit, surrounded by friends.

Aarav was smiling... until he saw something strange.
Dev and Samar were already sitting in the birthday seat.

"Hey, that's for Aarav!" someone called.

But Dev just shrugged. "We sat here first. He can sit on the other side."

Aarav froze.
Half the class was watching.
Dev was one of the loudest kids in class — popular, always joking. Samar too. Aarav had always wanted to be part of their group. This could be his chance.

He slowly walked over. "Can I sit in the middle?"

Dev looked up, smirking. "Chill, bro, it's just a seat. Come sit here."
He patted the chair far away from the center.

Aarav hesitated. His best friend, Kabir, was looking at him from behind, frowning slightly.
He could push back — tell them it was his seat today.
Or laugh it off, sit quietly, and don't cause drama.

His heart pounded.

He Had A Choice:

- *Go along with Dev to stay in the group — even if it felt unfair.*
- *Or say something, even if it risks rejection.*

At that moment, the "Power of We" wasn't about everyone being nice.
It was about what Aarav valued in relationships: respect, space, and voice.
And whether he believed he deserved it.

What do you think Aarav should do?
We all know about being "smart" — answering questions, solving problems, remembering facts.

But there's another kind of smart that we don't always learn about in school.

It's called ***relational intelligence*** *— and it's the superpower of understanding people.*

Relational intelligence means noticing how others feel, how your words affect them, and how to keep relationships healthy — even when things get tricky.

Let's go back to Aarav's story.

It's his birthday.

He has the right to the birthday seat.

But when his classmates act like it doesn't matter, he's stuck.

Should he speak up? Stay quiet? Laugh it off?

His choice isn't just about a seat.

It's about something deeper:

- *How does he see himself in a group?*
- *Does he believe he matters?*
- *How much should he adjust to keep the peace, and when is it okay to say "no" kindly?*

Relational Intelligence is about:

- ***Listening deeply*** *— not just to words, but to tone, face, and silence.*
- ***Knowing your feelings*** *so you don't dump them on others.*
- ***Understanding differences*** *— that not everyone thinks or feels like you.*
- ***Balancing "Me" and "We"*** *— respecting others and yourself.*

A Simple Way to Understand It:

- *Your brain is like a calculator — it solves numbers.*
- *Your relational intelligence is like a mirror and a bridge.*

It reflects what's inside you, and it connects you to others.

Relational intelligence doesn't always mean agreeing or being everyone's friend.
It means being aware, clear, and kind — even when things get messy.

It helps you in groups, in friendships, in your family, and even online.
It helps you choose your people — and not just follow the crowd.

When you grow this smart, you don't just win arguments—
You build trust, understanding, and a real connection.

That's the true ***Power of We****.*

Mirror Time: Questions to Build Your "We" Power

You are a part of many circles — friends, classmates, family, teams, and groups.

Relational Intelligence means learning how to move through these circles with awareness.

Not perfectly — just honestly and kindly.
Let's explore how you connect with others.

Take a quiet moment to think or write about these:

- ✓ *How do you usually respond when someone interrupts you, takes your seat, or ignores you?*
- ✓ *Do you speak up, laugh it off, stay silent, or walk away?*
- ✓ *Have you ever noticed someone being left out or disrespected in a group?*

- ✓ *What did you feel?*
- ✓ *Did you do anything? What stopped you or moved you?*
- ✓ *What kind of friend are you?*
- ✓ *The listener? The leader? The peacemaker? The honest one?*
- ✓ *What do you need more of in your friendships?*
- ✓ *Can you think of a moment when someone respected your space, included you, or stood up for you?*
- ✓ *How did that feel?*
- ✓ *Did it change how you saw that person?*
- ✓ *Who do you feel truly seen by?*
- ✓ *A friend, a sibling, a cousin, a teacher?*
- ✓ *What do they do that makes you feel understood?*
- ✓ *When you're upset or hurt in a relationship, how do you usually respond?*
- ✓ *Do you hide it, say it sharply, or talk gently about it?*
- ✓ *What's one thing you'd like to get better at?*

Relational intelligence isn't something you "use" only when things go wrong.

It's part of how you ***walk through the world*** *every single day —*

in texts, in classrooms, on lunch tables, in your tone of voice, and even in your silence.

Here's how it shows up in real life:

- ***In-Class Discussions***
  A friend gives the wrong answer. The class giggles.

You know what the teacher is really asking.

Do you raise your hand proudly, or do you look at your friend with kindness first?

- Relational moment: Being smart without making others feel small.

- **On WhatsApp or Group Chats**

  Someone's left unread.

  A mean sticker is sent after someone shares a selfie.

  The group laughs, but you feel a weird twist in your gut.

  - Relational moment: Do you stay silent? Or text them later and say, "Hey, you, okay?"

- **During Lunch Break**

  Your usual group is joking loudly.

  A quieter classmate walks by and seems to want to join in.

  They don't say anything.

  - Relational moment: Do you notice? Do you scoot over and make space?

- **In Family Arguments**

  Your sibling starts yelling.

  Your parent is tired.

  You feel stuck in between.

  - Relational moment: Can you stay calm, speak clearly, or even be the one who listens first?

- **When You Mess Up**

  You interrupt a friend. Forget their birthday. Say something without thinking.

  You feel it later — that oops feeling.

  - Relational moment: Can you own it and say, "I'm sorry— I didn't mean to hurt you"?

- ***Why This Matters***

  Being relationally intelligent doesn't mean being perfect.

  It means being:
  Aware of how you impact others
  Willing to repair when needed
  Brave enough to show care and set boundaries

Relational intelligence is the kind of intelligence that makes you someone others ***trust, respect,*** *and* ***feel safe with****.*

"The Broken Tap"

Every morning before school, Meher brushed her teeth while the water ran — just like always.

But this morning, something felt different.
Outside her window, two giant water tankers rumbled past. Her father muttered under his breath, "That's the third time this week. What's going on with the supply?"

At school, Ms. Devika explained that the city was running out of groundwater.

"Water tables are falling," she said. "Some areas are only getting water once a day."

Meher blinked. Once a day?
Her own water was always there. She had a filter, a geyser, and a running tap.

That evening, her grandmother said something Meher couldn't forget:
"Child, we used to walk three kilometers to fill one pot. We never wasted a drop. This Earth doesn't belong to us — we belong to it."

That night, brushing her teeth again, Meher stared at the running tap.

Her hand reached forward.
She turned it off.
Just stood there — toothbrush in mouth, heart full of thought.

For the first time, she wasn't just brushing her teeth.
She was making a choice.
A quiet one.
But a powerful one.

A citizen's choice.

What Does It Mean to Be a Conscious Citizen?

Most people think "citizenship" means having a passport or voting when you're older.

But that's just one part.

***Conscious citizenship** starts much earlier — in our daily choices, small actions, and how we see ourselves in the bigger world.*

Let's go back to Meher.

She didn't give a speech. She didn't go to a protest.
She turned off the tap — and turned on her awareness.

That's where conscious citizenship begins:
In the moment you realize, "I'm not separate from this planet. I'm a part of it. I belong to the Earth, and it belongs to me."

We are all connected — to the water we drink, the trees outside our window, the people who pick our fruits, and the air that flows through every breath.

But many of us grow up thinking we're just "users" — consumers of Earth's things.

Conscious citizenship flips that thinking:

*From **taking** → to **caring***

*From **me only** → to **we all***

*From **using the Earth** → to **being part of it***

A Simple Way to Understand It:

- *Your brain is like a smartphone — it helps you connect.*
- *But your Earth-Heart is like Wi-Fi — it connects you to everything, even the things you can't see.*

Being a conscious citizen means:

- ✓ *Turning off the tap not just for bills, but because someone else might need that drop.*
- ✓ *Picking up trash not for praise, but because this planet is your home.*
- ✓ *Caring about where your things come from — and where they go.*

It's not about being perfect.

It's about being aware, awake, and kind — to the Earth, to people, and to life itself.

You don't have to wait to grow up to care.

You already belong.

The Earth isn't a thing you live on — it's something you live with.

Mirror Time: Questions for Your Earth-Heart

Take a quiet moment.

Imagine the Earth not just as land and sky, but as a living being you're in a relationship with.

*Let's see what your **Earth-Heart** wants to say.*

Reflect And Write (Or Think Deeply):

What's something in nature you love and feel connected to?

A tree, a lake, your garden, a stray dog, the moon?
Why do you love it?

Have you ever felt sad, angry, or surprised seeing someone harm the Earth?

What did they do? How did it make you feel?

What's one habit you've never questioned — like keeping lights on, using plastic, throwing food — that maybe needs a closer look?

How might that choice affect someone else?

Do you think grown-ups always model conscious citizenship well?

Where do they inspire you — and where do they fall short?

What's one thing you could do this week to care for the Earth more mindfully?

Small counts: Carrying a water bottle? Reusing paper? Fixing something instead of throwing it?

Have you ever spoken up (even softly) when someone did something careless to the planet?

How did it feel? Scary, awkward, or brave?

"If the Earth could speak to me, I think it would say…"
(Write as if the Earth were your pen pal, friend, or even grandparent.)

These reflections build the roots of conscious citizenship — not with pressure, but with presence.
You don't need to do everything. You need to begin noticing.

Where Does Conscious Citizenship Show Up?

You don't need to be a grown-up, an activist, or a science genius to care for the Earth.

You're already making choices — every single day — that connect you to the planet.

Let's explore where this shows up in your normal life:

1. ***Brushing Teeth or Bathing***
   - *Tap running for 5 extra minutes = 25 litres wasted.*
   - ***Conscious moment:*** *Can you turn it off when not in use? Could you challenge your family to a water-saving week?*

2. ***Food on the Plate***

   A third of all food is wasted globally.

   You didn't like the dal today, so you threw it. Someone else didn't eat all week.

   - ***Conscious moment:*** *Could you start with less? Try a new dish instead of rejecting it. Share extra with someone in need?*

3. ***Online Shopping***

   Ordering a pencil box from a big website.

   It comes in 3 layers of plastic + 1 cardboard box = trees cut + fossil fuels burned.

   - ***Conscious moment:*** *Could you buy local? Share with a friend? Ask for less packaging next time?*

4. ***Packaged Snacks***

   A chip packet takes 5 minutes to finish. The wrapper will live in a landfill for 500 years.

- ***Conscious moment:*** *Could you shift to fruits, homemade snacks, or carry your own jar?*

5. ***School Projects***

   Making 3 chart papers for a one-day event. Glitters, thermocol, and sketch pens used once — then trashed.

   - ***Conscious moment:*** *Can you reuse, create from waste, or go digital? Could you lead a "green creativity" project in class?*

6. ***Looking the Other Way***

   You see someone littering, wasting water, or cutting trees. You think, "Not my problem."

   - ***Conscious moment:*** *Could you say something? Or choose to do the opposite — clean, save, plant, protect?*

The Real Truth?

The Earth doesn't need more people who know stuff.
It needs more people who care enough to act.

You don't have to be perfect.
You have to ***show up****.*

Again and again.
In small, steady ways.
That's what citizens do.

Section-5

Is It Really True???



Sometimes, what we think is true is only one way of looking at a situation.

Many times we have been upset with a friend, only to discover later that there was a misunderstanding. Have you ever thought a teacher was being unfair, and then realized they were trying to help? Or have you ever looked at a difficult challenge and thought,

"I can't do this."
Only to surprise yourself later?

The truth is:
We do not see the world exactly as it is.

As we learned earlier, we see the world through our experiences, feelings, beliefs, and memories. And because everyone has different experiences, everyone sees things a little differently.

That doesn't mean someone is right and someone is wrong.

It simply means there may be more than one way to understand the same situation.

Fun Activity: My Learning Map

Take a blank sheet of paper.
Write your name in the center.
Now draw branches showing things you have learned so far in life.

You can include:

Sports

Hobbies

School Subjects

Friendships

Family Lessons

Mistakes You Learned From

Life Skills

Nature

Creativity

Every time you learn something new, add another branch.

You might be surprised by how much you already know.

The Elephant Puzzle

Imagine five people standing around a giant elephant.

One person touches its leg.
"It's a tree!" they say.

Another touches its trunk.
"No, it's a snake!"

A third touches its ear.
"You're both wrong. It's a giant fan!"

Who is correct?
The answer is: all of them are seeing part of the truth.

But none of them is seeing the whole elephant.

Life is often like that.

When we only look from one angle, we may miss important pieces of the picture.

The more perspectives we consider, the clearer our understanding becomes.

Changing the Lens

Our perspective is like a pair of glasses.

Different glasses show different pictures.

Let's see how changing our perspective can change our experience.

School

× *"School is boring and pointless."*

✓ *"School helps me discover things I don't know yet."*

Friends

× *"My friends are the only people who understand me."*

✓ *"My friends are important, but my family, teachers, and other trusted adults can help me too."*

Challenges

× *"If something feels difficult, I must not be good at it."*

✓ *"Difficult things often help me grow stronger."*

Mistakes

× *"I made a mistake. I failed."*

✓ *"I made a mistake. I learned something."*

Feedback

× *"Someone corrected me because they don't like me."*

✓ *"Someone corrected me because they noticed something I can improve."*

Mirror Time

Think about a recent situation that upset you.

Now ask yourself:

✓ *Is there another way to look at this?*

✓ *What might the other person be thinking or feeling?*

✓ *What facts do I know for sure?*

✓ *What am I assuming?*

- ✓ *If my best friend were in this situation, what advice would I give them?*

Write your answers in your journal.

The Perspective Superpower

People who can see situations from different angles often:

- ✓ *Solve problems better*
- ✓ *Understand others more easily*
- ✓ *Make wiser decisions*
- ✓ *Stay calmer during challenges*
- ✓ *Learn faster from mistakes*

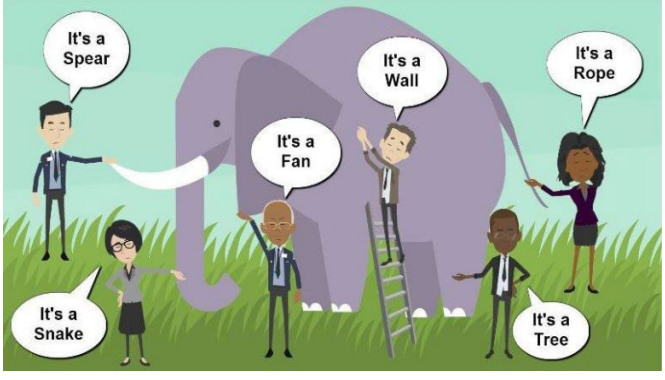
Seeing different perspectives doesn't mean changing who you are. It means being curious enough to ask:

"What else could be true?"

That simple question can open doors to understanding, growth, and better decisions.

Sometimes the biggest change in life doesn't happen when the situation changes.

Sometimes it happens when our perspective changes.



Section-6

Tiny Steps Create Big Changes!!!



By the time you finish reading this page, your mind will have already processed hundreds of thoughts. Some thoughts may be about school, friends, family, social media, games, exams, your future, or something that happened earlier today. Most of these thoughts arrive automatically. We rarely stop to ask where they came from or whether they are helping us become the person we want to be.

Think about a normal day in your life. You wake up, check your phone, talk to people, attend classes, watch videos, play games, listen to music, scroll through social media, and have conversations with friends and family. It may seem like nothing extraordinary is happening. Yet, something very important is taking place. Every experience is quietly shaping the way you think, what you believe, the choices you make, and the person you are becoming.

Many people believe that their future will be decided by one big event. They think success will come from one great opportunity, one important examination, one special talent, or one lucky moment. However, life rarely works that way. The truth is that our future is often built by the small things we do repeatedly. A single workout does not make someone healthy. A single page does not complete a book. A single practice session does not make someone a great musician. Growth happens through small actions repeated consistently over time.

Imagine two students who start the year together. Both have similar abilities. One student decides to spend just fifteen

minutes every day learning something new, asking questions, reading, observing, and improving. The other student keeps waiting for the perfect time to start. At the end of the year, the difference between them may seem surprising. The difference was not created in one day. It was created through hundreds of tiny decisions that nobody noticed at the time.

Life is very similar. The thoughts we repeat become beliefs. The beliefs we hold influence our actions. Our actions become habits, and our habits slowly shape our character. This process happens so gradually that we often do not notice it. Yet, whether we realize it or not, we are becoming someone every single day.

Today's world makes this even more important. Never before in human history have young people had access to so much information. Within minutes, you can watch videos from different countries, learn from experts, listen to opinions, receive advice from artificial intelligence, and communicate with people across the world. This is an incredible opportunity, but it also comes with a challenge. Not everything we hear is true. Not everything we see is helpful. Not everything we believe helps us grow.

That is why learning to think clearly, understand your values, manage your emotions, choose your influences wisely, and make thoughtful decisions has become one of the most important life skills of our time. The future will not only belong to people who know information. It will belong to people who know how to think about information.

This chapter is not about changing your entire life overnight. It is about understanding the small things that quietly shape your future. It is about becoming aware of your thoughts, habits, values, emotions, friendships, and the information you allow into your mind. Most importantly, it is about discovering

that meaningful change does not begin with giant leaps. It begins with tiny steps.

As you read this chapter, remember one simple idea: the person you become tomorrow is being shaped by the choices you make today. Every thought, every action, every question, and every decision is like a small vote for the person you are becoming. The good news is that no matter where you are today, you can begin taking better steps.

Tiny steps may seem small, but over time they create big changes.

Becoming Aware of Yourself

Before changing anything, we must notice it.

Paste these in places where you stay the most

Always stay here - Live here



- *Who is making decisions, you or your little voice?*
- *Always stick to your Values.*
- *What does my body language reflect about me at present?*
- *I learned something new today.*
- *Yes, I am better than yesterday.*
- *Yes, I have expressed myself today.*
- *Happy that I took a step today as well to overcome my fears.*

- *Yes, I connect with Trees easily.*
- *I can't control others' behavior, so I focus on myself and my required action.*
- *I don't get what I want, but I work for it.*
- *I learn by asking about it.*
- *We learn things step by step. One step at a time, and every step takes time.*
- *We assume the 1st thing you see, hear, or feel is the basis of our thoughts. Truth is what you see after it.*
- *Always gather at least 2 points of view on any given situation.*
- *Everything is about using your brain, not just following what is happening around.*

Enhance your learning. You can be better without any courses or anything else. You shall not spend any money or time anywhere. You need to change your way of thinking and learn to accept and work on yourself in daily life.

We are our thoughts; it's been said many a time. So, we need to be careful what we take into our brains, as with any information.

Once we begin noticing ourselves, another question appears: How do we know whether what we think and believe is actually true?

Becoming A Truth Detective

Let's dive deep into various aspects that require attention and what can serve as tools for a better tomorrow.

1. **Critical Thinking Is:**

   Critical thinking means carefully evaluating information before accepting it as true. Critical thinking is like being

a detective. You don't just believe everything you hear; you look for clues and evidence to find out what's true.

Example: *Just like you read food labels to know what's healthy, you should also check information before believing it.*

It starts with asking the 5 aspects: When, why, where, how, and what. It would open new avenues and new ways of looking at the same situation.

In the time of AI and Technological devices, we have to be ready to counter the effects of AI

2. *Teach Fact-Checking Techniques*

Identify Reliable Sources

Explain What Reliable Sources Are: Look for information from credible sources such as educational institutions, reputable news organizations, and official websites.

Example: *A website ending in .edu, .gov, or .org is usually more reliable than a random blog or social media post.*

Cross-Check Information

- ***Compare Multiple Sources:*** *Compare information from different sources to see if it matches. Example: If you read something interesting online, check a few other websites to see if they say the same thing.*

Verify with Experts

- ***Seek Expert Opinions:*** *Consult experts or trusted adults when unsure about the accuracy of information. Example: If you read something about science, ask your science teacher if it's true.*

3. ***Encourage Skepticism and Questioning***

- ***Ask Questions:*** *Ask who, what, where, when, why, and how about the information they come across. Example: When you see a news story, ask yourself: Who wrote this? What is their source? Why are they saying this?*

Healthy Skepticism

- ***Promote Healthy Skepticism:*** *Be cautious and do not accept everything at face value, especially if it seems too good to be true. Example: If something sounds too amazing or scary, it's a good idea to double-check it before you believe it.*

4. ***Discuss Media Literacy***

Recognize Bias and Persuasion

- ***Explain Bias:*** *Learn to recognize bias and understand that people or organizations might present information in a way that supports their own views or interests. Example: If a company tells you their product is the best, remember they are trying to sell something, so they might not tell the whole story.*

Identify Persuasive Techniques

- ***Spot Persuasive Language:*** *Remember, advertisements, social media posts, and articles might use persuasive language to influence their opinions. Example: Ads often use words like 'amazing' or 'best' to make you feel excited about their product. Look for facts rather than just emotions.*

5. ***Practical Exercises and Activities***

Fact-Checking Activities

- ***Interactive Fact-Checking:*** *Engage in activities where they practice fact-checking, like verifying a news*

story together. Example Activity: Find a news story online, then work together to identify three additional sources that confirm or contradict it.

Debate and Discussion

- ***Host Debates:*** *Do debates on various topics where they have to present evidence to support their points. Example Activity: Choose a topic such as 'Should kids have homework?' and have them find facts to support their arguments.*

6. ***Model Critical Thinking and Fact-Checking***

- ***Demonstrate Fact-Checking:*** *Regularly demonstrate how you verify information in your daily life. Example: When you see a headline online, say, 'Let's check if this is true by looking it up on a few reliable news sites.'*

Discuss News and Information Together

- ***Shared Media Consumption:*** *Watch the news or read articles together and discuss the content critically. Example: After reading a news article, ask, 'What do you think about this? How can we find out if it's true?'*

7. ***Teach the Risks of Misinformation***

- ***Discuss Potential Harms:*** *Explain how misinformation can lead to wrong decisions, fear, or the spreading of false news. Example: Believing and sharing false health information can lead people to do things that harm them rather than help them.*

- ***Case Studies:*** *Talk about a viral hoax that caused panic or a false health claim that led to people getting sick.*

Now you know how to understand & adapt to any topic in life.

But do you know what information or knowledge we agree on that others might not agree on? The difference is in the value of the individual. These values differ from individual to Individual. We all need to know our values. Below are some details related to that for you to work on.

Examples: *Honesty, Respect, Responsibility, Kindness, Empathy, Perseverance, Fairness, Gratitude, Courage, Patience, Self-Discipline, Integrity, Forgiveness, Optimism, Humility,*

Even after checking facts, people can still reach different conclusions. Why? Because facts are only part of the story.

Values: Your Internal Compass

Values also influence how we see the world. Values play a crucial role in shaping our lives, guiding our behavior, and influencing our decision-making processes. They serve as a moral compass, helping us determine what is important, right, and meaningful. Here's a detailed look at the role of values in life, especially in the context of accepting and believing information.

<u>The Role of Values in Life</u>

1. ***Guiding Principles***
    - ***Moral Framework:*** *Values provide a framework for making ethical decisions. They help us discern right from wrong and guide our actions in various situations.*

      Example: *If honesty is a core value, a person will strive to be truthful in their interactions, even when it's challenging.*

2. ***Influencing Behavior***
    - ***Consistent Actions:*** *Values influence how we behave consistently across different aspects of life, from personal relationships to professional conduct.*

Example: *A person who values kindness will likely volunteer to help others and show empathy in their daily interactions.*

3. ***Shaping Identity***
   - ***Sense of Self:*** *Values contribute to our sense of identity and self-worth. They reflect what we stand for and who we are as individuals.*

     Example: *Someone who values education may prioritize learning and self- improvement, seeing themselves as a lifelong learner.*

4. ***Determining Priorities***
   - ***Decision-Making:*** *Values help us prioritize our time, energy, and resources. They influence what we consider important and worth pursuing.*

     Example: *If family is a core value, a person might prioritize spending time with loved ones over career advancement.*

<u>The Role of Values in Accepting and Believing Information</u>

1. ***Filtering Information***
   Bias and Preferences: *Our values act as filters through which we evaluate and interpret information. They can create biases that influence what information we accept or reject.*

   Example: *If environmental conservation is a value, a person may be more likely to accept information from sources that support green initiatives.*

2. ***Critical Evaluation***
   Questioning Relevance: *Values help us assess the relevance and importance of information. We are more likely to scrutinize information that conflicts with our values.*

Example: *A person who values justice may critically evaluate news stories about social issues to ensure they align with their understanding of fairness.*

3. ***Influencing Beliefs***

   Aligning with Values: *Information that aligns with our values is more likely to be believed and integrated into our worldview. Conversely, information that contradicts our values may be rejected or questioned.*

   Example: *Someone who values health and wellness may readily accept scientific information about the benefits of exercise and healthy eating.*

4. ***Promoting Integrity***

   Consistency with Values: *Accepting and acting on information that aligns with our values promotes integrity and authenticity. It ensures that our beliefs and actions are consistent with who we are.*

   Example: *If transparency is a value, a person may favor open and honest communication and be wary of information from sources that seem secretive or misleading.*

Practical Applications and Examples

Educational Setting

- ***Teaching Critical Thinking:*** *Educators can teach students to evaluate information based on their values. For instance, in a classroom discussion about ethics, students can be encouraged to consider how different values influence their acceptance of various viewpoints.*

Personal Relationships

- ***Building Trust:*** *In relationships, shared values can strengthen trust and understanding. When partners or*

friends share core values, they are more likely to believe in and support each other's perspectives.

Conclusion

Values play a fundamental role in shaping our lives by guiding our decisions, influencing our behavior, and forming our identity. When it comes to accepting and believing information, values act as filters that help us evaluate its relevance, credibility, and alignment with our core beliefs. By understanding and reflecting on our values, we can make more informed, consistent, and ethical choices in both our personal and public lives. Our values influence our decisions. And our decisions influence how we treat people.

Understanding ourselves, questioning information, living by our values, and building healthy relationships are not things we do once.

They are tiny steps we practice every day.

But how shall I deal with unfamiliar people in life?

Here's an approach with practical steps and conversations to help you navigate these feelings and improve friendship:

Step-by-Step Guide

1. **Self-Reflection**

   Identify the Problem: Think about specific behaviors or situations that make you feel that the people around you are toxic or not understanding.

   Example:

   Problem: They always make fun of me and never listen when I try to tell them something important. It makes me feel sad and unimportant. Communicate your feelings to your friends assertively and calmly.

   When you talk to your friends, try saying, 'I feel hurt when you make fun of me because it makes me feel unimportant.'

2. **Use "I" Statements:**

   Encourage the use of I statements to express feelings without sounding accusatory.

   Example: *I feel sad when you don't listen to me because it makes me feel like my opinions don't matter.*

3. **Set Boundaries**

   Define Acceptable Behavior: *Set clear boundaries with their friends. It's important to let your friends know what kind of behavior is not okay with you. You can say,'I don't like it when you make fun of me. Please stop.*

4. **Choose Friends Wisely**

   Evaluate Friendships: *Think about which friendships are positive and which might be causing more harm than good. Think about the friends who make you feel happy and those who often make you feel sad. Who do you think you should spend more time with? Spend more time with friends who are supportive and understanding. Try spending more time with friends who listen to you and make you feel good about yourself.*

5. **Develop Social Skills**

   Practice Empathy: *Understand others' perspectives to improve mutual understanding. Sometimes, it helps to think about why your friends might be acting the way they are. Maybe they don't realize they're hurting you.*

   Improve Communication Skills: *Role-play various scenarios to practice handling conflicts and expressing feelings effectively. Let's pretend I'm one of your friends. Practice telling me how you feel when I don't listen to you.*

6. ***Seek Support***

   Talk to a Trusted Adult: *Talk to a teacher, parent, or another trusted adult if you need more help. If you feel like you need more help with your friends, it's okay to talk to your teacher or parent.*

Sample Conversations

Conversation 1: Child with Parent

Child: *My friends are so mean sometimes. They never listen to me.*

Parent: *Can you tell me more about what actually happened?*

Child: *They always make fun of me and ignore what I say.*

Parent: *That is hurtful. I understand. How do you feel when they do that?*

Child: *I don't know, but I feel really sad and like they don't care about me.*

Parent: *I understand. It's important to let them know how you feel. You can say, 'I feel sad when you make fun of me because it makes me feel like my opinions don't matter.'*

Child: *But what if they don't listen? I know they will not listen to me on this, either.*

Parent: *If they don't listen, it might be helpful to spend more time with friends who do listen and make you feel good about yourself. You deserve friends who respect and understand you.*

Conversation 2: Child with Teacher

Child: *Mam, I feel like my friends are always ignoring me and making fun of me.*

Teacher: *Ok. It's important to feel respected and valued by your friends. Have you tried talking to them about how you feel?*

Child: *No, I'm afraid they'll laugh at me.*

Teacher: *It can be hard to speak up, but sometimes friends don't realize they're hurting you. You can try saying something like, 'I feel upset when you ignore me because it makes me feel left out.' Would you like me to help you with this?*

Child: *Yes, please. I need some help. Will you talk to them for me?*

Teacher: *No, Let's practice together on how to put our point differently, and I'll be here to support you.*

Conversation 3: Child with Friend
Child: *Hey, can we talk for a minute?*

Friend: *Sure, please tell.*

Child: *I feel really hurt when you make fun of me. It makes me feel like you don't care about my feelings.*

Friend: *I didn't realize you felt that way. I'm sorry. I was joking around.*

Child: *I know you didn't mean to hurt me, but it still makes me feel bad. Can we try to be more respectful to each other?*

Friend: *Yeah, I can do that. Thanks for telling me.*

Conclusion

Improving a situation involves self-reflection and effective communication. This would help you navigate your social relationships more confidently and in a healthier way.

Your Tiny Step Challenge

Bonus Activity :
"Try to question 1 thing you hear, act from 1 value, and notice 1 emotion every day for 3 days. Write what you learned."

- *My Thoughts Today*
  What kind of thoughts did you notice in your mind today? Were they kind, critical, fast, funny, or curious?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- *What I Believe About Myself Complete this sentence with honesty: "I believe I am someone who…"*

  _____
  _____
  _____

- *Where do you think this belief came from?*
  A person, an event, something someone said?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- *When I Compare Myself…*
  Who did I compare myself to?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- *What did I feel after the comparison?*
  - *Happy*
  - *Confused*
  - *Not Good Enough*
  - *Motivated*
  - *Other*

  _____
  _____
  _____

- *If that person knew how I felt, what would I want them to say to me?*

  _____
  _____
  _____

- *Expressing My Emotions*

  Choose one emotion you felt strongly today (anger, sadness, joy, fear, embarrassment, excitement, etc.). What caused it?

  What did you do with that feeling? What could you try next time?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- *Turning Negative Feelings into Power*

  Let's name one "negative" feeling you experienced this week. What was the situation?

  How did you react?

  What would your "wise inner guide" suggest you do next time?

  _____
  _____
  _____

- *A Message to Myself*

  Dear [Your Name], I want you to know that...

  _____
  _____
  _____

Top 5 Self-Check Reminders

1. *Thoughts are visitors — not rulers.*
2. *Beliefs can be changed with awareness.*
3. *You are enough — comparisons don't define you.*
4. *Every emotion is a message worth listening to.*
5. *You can always choose your next step with kindness.*

Keep this card near your study space or journal. Re-read when you feel lost or unsure.

Section-7

Support System In Life



Imagine a sports team preparing for an important match. Most people notice the players on the field, but behind every successful team are coaches, trainers, supporters, groundskeepers, and many others working quietly in the background. Life is very similar. Behind every person you admire stands an invisible team that has helped shape their journey.

Some offered support, some provided opportunities, some gave advice, and some taught valuable lessons through challenges. Understanding this invisible team helps us appreciate how connected our lives really are.

We are all meant to take action, and our surroundings are our resources in life for achieving a bigger goal.

Others do carry a perspective for us, and we base our discussions on seeing others through that understanding & set of parameters only.

Sometimes we make quick judgments about people based on how they look, what they wear, or what we've heard about them. This is like looking at them through a lens that can change how we see them".

We assume and make a story we believe in

Example:

Parent: *Imagine you're meeting a new student in your class. What if you decided they weren't friendly just because they*

were quiet on the first day? How might that stop you from making a new friend?

Child: *I guess I wouldn't get to know them.*

Parent: *Exactly. Sometimes we see people through a lens of our own ideas and experiences. But if we drop that lens and really try to get to know them, we can see the real person. It's like when you thought your new soccer coach was strict at first, but then you found out they were really nice and helpful.*

Child: *Oh, yeah. I see what you mean.*

Parent: *So next time, let's try to learn more about people before deciding what they're like. Everyone has a story, just like you.*

All the people around me in this life, apart from ME, are part of the resources required to live well.

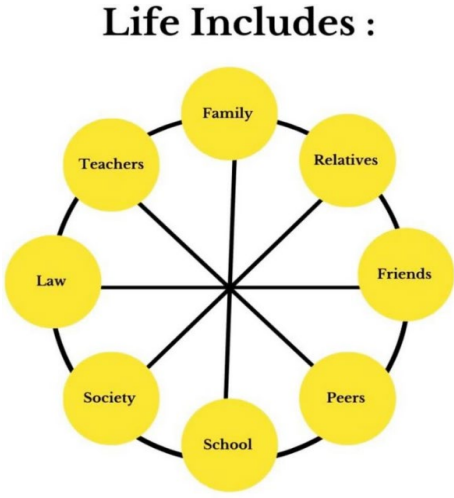
- ***Someone who listens to you:*** *They help you express yourself and let you be as you want to be.*
- ***Someone who doesn't listen to you:*** *He is to create a place for someone in your life where you know what kind of person you want to live with and express yourself freely.*
- ***Those who stop you from doing a task: They are sent to bring out your creativity****, to ignite you to create your own path, and to develop patience in you. Now, creating such a path, or choosing to feel like a victim, is your choice, and your life is as you choose it to be.*
- ***Those who raise us: They raise us by teaching us culture and values during our developmental years****. They teach us things at various stages of our lives. We tale/make decisions based on our values, and we see things as right or wrong based on our cultural acceptance of them.*

- ***Those who criticize you:*** *They take you to see the other way possible; they are sent to you to see a new perspective which you would not otherwise know or wish to see.*

- ***Those who give you a chance: They believe in your ability and trust you to*** *do what you are capable of. They give you a ground to play and showcase your potential.*

We need to accept all those around us, as they are all part of one big story meant to grow you and help you grow.

The Invisible Team Around You



I can see parents teaching us Values & fixing our Beliefs, giving us direction to move ahead (when alone), and providing us with all that is required to live with confidence, space, resources, thoughts, etc.

Peers *play an important role in shaping our beliefs and thoughts. We learn from family, i.e., parents & siblings, as we all stay together and act the same way in any given situation, and peers help us navigate life when our parents are not available.*

Friends *give me space to share myself and accept me as I am, unlike parents, who want us to walk a path they decide for us. But do you know why? Because friends feel the same at their home. A friend serves as a listener in our lives. We are at times unable to share our thoughts/fears/expressions with family due to fear/non-reliability/non- fulfillment of the desired results from them.*

Relatives *play an important role in our lives. They are physically far from us, but they are the ones who stand with us in our hard times & happy moments & when it matters most in our lives. We may hold a different perception of them, but that doesn't change how and where they are positioned in our lives.*

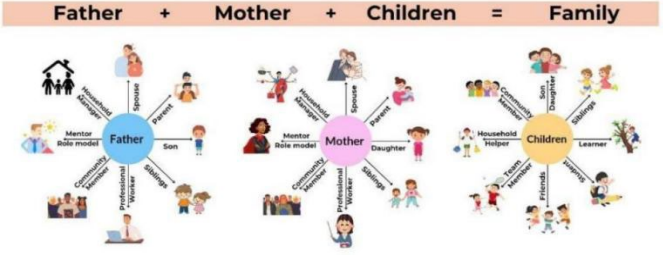
Everyone around us in our ***Society/Community*** *plays a very important part in identifying what we like/require and what we do not. We may see some as useless people, idiots, to be ignored, of lesser intellect, or otherwise. But we miss the point that we are all unique, and only together do we make this world complete, and because of that, only we can identify who is right and who is not in our world.*

If you miss any of the community workers, even from the community, you can see there is a need for someone to fill that gap. Together, we make the world a livable place.

School/College *plays an important role in our lives. They give us a playground where we can use what we learned in our childhood. It also provides diversity in terms of Values, religions, and social skills. We learn a lot about how we should behave, how we should work as one, how we are different, how we respect each other, and how we need to behave properly.*

Humans play many roles in life, and we always have expectations of them based on what we want.

Role	Responsibilities (Father)	Responsibilities (Mother)
Parent	Providing care, discipline, and support	Providing nurturing, caregiving, and support
Spouse/Partner	Supporting spouse, sharing household responsibilities	Supporting spouse, sharing household responsibilities
Son/Daughter	Supporting and respecting parents	Supporting and respecting parents
Sibling	Offering support and companionship	Offering support and companionship
Professional/Worker	Contributing to family's financial stability, balancing work and family life	Balancing career and family, contributing to financial stability
Community Member	Participating in community activities and volunteering	Participating in community activities and volunteering
Mentor/Role Model	Guiding children, providing advice and example	Guiding children, providing advice and example
Household Manager	Handling household maintenance and logistics	Managing daily household tasks and schedules



The Power of Self-Talks

Have you ever noticed the voice inside your head when something goes wrong? Sometimes it encourages us, and sometimes it criticizes us. This inner voice can influence how we feel about ourselves and how we respond to challenges. Positive self-talk does not mean pretending that problems do not exist. It means speaking to ourselves with honesty, kindness, and encouragement. The way we talk to ourselves often becomes the foundation of how we face the world. Positive self-talk can greatly enhance emotional resilience and relationship-building skills. Here are 50 positive self-talk sentences categorized by specific situations:

General Emotional Support

1. *I am capable of handling this.*
2. *This feeling will pass, and I will feel better soon.*
3. *I am strong and brave.*
4. *I can take deep breaths and calm down.*
5. *I am learning and growing every day.*

When Facing Failure or Mistakes

1. Everyone makes mistakes, and that's how we learn.
2. It's okay not to be perfect.
3. I can try again and do better next time.
4. Failure is a part of success.
5. I am proud of myself for trying.

Dealing with Peer Pressure or Negative Comments

1. I am confident in my own choices.
2. Other people's opinions do not define me.
3. I can stand up for myself in a kind way.
4. I know what is right for me.
5. I am valuable just the way I am.

Feeling Overwhelmed or Stressed

1. I can take one step at a time.
2. It's okay to ask for help when I need it.
3. I can handle this one moment at a time.
4. I am doing my best, and that's enough.
5. I can find ways to relax and feel better.

Improving Self-Image and Self-Esteem

1. I am unique and special.
2. I love and accept myself just as I am.
3. I have many talents and abilities.
4. I am proud of who I am becoming.
5. I deserve to be happy and loved.

Building Positive Relationships

1. I can be kind to others and myself.
2. I listen and respect other people's feelings.
3. Good friends care about me.
4. I can solve conflicts peacefully.
5. I enjoy making others smile.

Handling Fear or Anxiety

1. *I am safe and protected.*
2. *I can face my fears and be brave.*
3. *It's okay to feel scared sometimes.*
4. *I dare to try new things.*
5. *I believe in myself.*

Encouraging Persistence and Effort

1. *I can keep going even when it's tough.*
2. *Every small step counts.*
3. *I am persistent and never give up.*
4. *I can overcome any obstacle.*
5. *I trust the process of growth.*

Managing Anger or Frustration

1. *I can calm myself with deep breaths.*
2. *It's okay to feel angry, but I can handle it.*
3. *I can express my feelings in healthy ways.*
4. *I am in control of my reactions.*
5. *I can choose to respond with kindness.*

Celebrating Achievements and Progress

1. *I am proud of what I have accomplished.*
2. *I celebrate my progress, no matter how small.*
3. *I acknowledge my efforts and hard work.*
4. *I appreciate my journey and where I am.*
5. *I am grateful for my abilities and strengths.*

In what ways can I keep myself positive against all odds???

<u>Gratitude: Seeing What We Already Have</u>

Yes, by looking at things positively. Practice Gratitude.

We naturally notice what is missing, what is difficult, and what still needs improvement. While this can help us grow, it can also make us overlook the good things already present in

our lives. Gratitude helps us shift our attention toward the people, opportunities, experiences, and resources that support us every day. It reminds us that even during challenging times, there are reasons to appreciate the journey and the people walking alongside us. Let's enter the world of Gratitude and make this part of our lives.

How to Express Gratitude

1. **Say Thank You:** *Verbally express thanks whenever someone does something kind or helpful. For example, thank you for helping me with my homework, Mom.*

2. **Write a Note:** *Create thank-you notes or cards for teachers, friends, or family members. A simple note like "Thank you for being a great friend" can go a long way.*

3. **Show Appreciation Through Actions:** *Do something nice in return, such as helping with chores or sharing a toy.*

4. **Keep a Gratitude Journal:** *Write down things you are thankful for each day. This can be a few sentences or even just a list.*

5. **Publicly Acknowledge:** *Share gratitude in front of others, such as during family dinners or class discussions.*

When to Express Gratitude

- **Daily:** *Make it a habit to find at least one thing to be grateful for each day.*

- **After Receiving Help:** *Immediately thank someone after they have helped you.*

- **Special Occasions:** *During birthdays, holidays, or special events, thank people for their gifts and presence.*

- **Random Acts of Kindness:** *When someone does something unexpectedly nice, acknowledge their effort.*

- ***Reflective Moments:*** *At the end of the day, reflect on and express gratitude for the positive experiences.*

Making Gratitude a Habit

1. ***Start Small:*** *Begin by writing down three things you're grateful for each day.*
2. ***Create Reminders:*** *Set reminders on your phone or have a visual cue, like a gratitude jar, where you can drop in notes of thanks.*
3. ***Involve the Family:*** *Have regular family discussions where everyone shares what they are grateful for.*
4. ***Practice Mindfulness:*** *Spend a few minutes each day reflecting on positive experiences and expressing gratitude for them.*
5. ***Lead by Example:*** *Watch and learn from how parents, teachers, and friends show gratitude, and try to emulate them.*

Life with Gratitude

When Practicing Gratitude

1. ***Increased Happiness:*** *Regularly focusing on positive aspects of life can boost overall happiness and satisfaction.*
2. ***Better Relationships:*** *Expressing gratitude strengthens bonds with family, friends, and peers. People feel valued and appreciated.*
3. ***Improved Mental Health:*** *Gratitude can reduce feelings of stress, anxiety, and depression by shifting focus away from negative thoughts.*
4. ***Enhanced Resilience:*** *Grateful individuals are better equipped to cope with challenges and setbacks.*

5. ***Greater Empathy:*** *Regularly practicing gratitude fosters a sense of empathy and compassion towards others.*

6. ***Positive Outlook:*** *Cultivating a habit of gratitude helps maintain a positive outlook on life, even during tough times.*

When Not Practicing Gratitude

1. ***Increased Negativity:*** *A lack of gratitude can lead to focusing on what's wrong in life rather than what's right, fostering a negative mindset.*

2. ***Strained Relationships:*** *Not expressing gratitude can make others feel unappreciated, potentially leading to conflicts or weakened relationships.*

3. ***Poor Mental Health:*** *Focusing on negative aspects can increase stress, anxiety, and feelings of depression.*

4. ***Decreased Resilience:*** *Without gratitude, it may be harder to cope with life's challenges and setbacks.*

5. ***Self-Centered Attitude:*** *A lack of gratitude can foster a sense of entitlement and selfishness, reducing empathy and compassion for others.*

6. ***Lower Life Satisfaction:*** *Overall life satisfaction may decrease as the focus remains on unmet desires and frustrations rather than on appreciating what one already has.*

Examples of Practicing Gratitude in Daily Life Situations

- ***Example 1: At School***
  - ***Situation:*** *Your teacher helps you understand a difficult concept.*
  - ***Gratitude Expression:*** *Thank you so much for explaining that to me. It really helped!*

- ***Example 2: With Family***
  - ***Situation:*** *Your sibling shares their favorite toy with you.*
  - ***Gratitude Expression:*** *Thanks for sharing your toy with me. I had a lot of fun playing with it!*
- ***Example 3: With Friends***
  - ***Situation:*** *Your friend invites you to their house to play.*
  - ***Gratitude Expression:*** *Thanks for having me over. I had a great time!*
- ***Example 4: Random Acts***
  - ***Situation:*** *A stranger holds the door open for you.*
  - ***Gratitude Expression:*** *Thank you for holding the door!*

Steps To Form A Gratitude Habit

1. ***Set a Regular Time:*** *Choose a time each day to reflect on and express gratitude, such as before bed or during dinner.*
2. ***Share Gratitude:*** *Share what you're thankful for with family or friends regularly.*
3. ***Model Behavior:*** *Watch how others show gratitude and follow their example.*
4. ***Keep It Simple:*** *Gratitude doesn't need to be grand. Simple, sincere thanks go a long way.*
5. ***Stay Consistent:*** *Consistency is key to forming any habit. Stick with your gratitude practice even on tough days.*

Reflection on Practicing Gratitude
Positive Impacts:

- ***Mood Improvement:*** *Regular gratitude practice can uplift your mood and make you more optimistic.*
- ***Better Relationships:*** *People appreciate being acknowledged, and this can strengthen bonds.*
- ***Resilience Building:*** *Gratitude can help you see the positives in difficult situations, making you more resilient.*

Negative Impacts of Not Practicing Gratitude:

- ***Increased Negativity:*** *You may find yourself dwelling on what's wrong rather than appreciating what's right.*
- ***Weaker Relationships:*** *Lack of gratitude can lead to feelings of being taken for granted among friends and family.*
- ***Lower Resilience:*** *Challenges may seem harder to overcome without the positive perspective that gratitude brings.*

How To Manage Expectations

- ***Be Realistic:*** *Understand that people may respond differently to gratitude. Some may be very appreciative, while others might not react as expected.*

  Example Talk: *Sometimes people might not show how much they appreciate you, but it still makes a difference. Keep expressing gratitude because it's important for you and them.*

- ***Respect Differences:*** *Everyone has their own way of showing and receiving gratitude. What matters is the genuine intention behind it.*

  Example Talk: *Not everyone shows their feelings the same way, and that's okay. Your sincere thanks will still be valued.*

Communication: Building Bridges With Others

No matter how much people care about us, they cannot read our minds. Many misunderstandings arise when thoughts and feelings go unspoken. Communication helps us express our needs, share our concerns, solve problems, and strengthen relationships. Like any skill, communication improves with practice. Learning to speak honestly, listen carefully, and respect different viewpoints helps us build stronger connections with the people around us.

There are some tips for improving this:

Reasons could be:

- *Low self-confidence*
- *Not finding the right way to say things*
- *Self-voice stops from taking a step*
- *Non-Fulfillment of expectations from others in terms of answers*

Some thoughts on sharing our thoughts

Q1 Others also don't share themselves:

- *What is really required is our will to move ahead and talk because sharing is more than fearing for the outcome or else.*
- *Living another's way of life is equal to cheating yourself.*
- *We have to find a solution to our problems; they are not you, and you are not they.*
- *Only when you are free mentally can you create space for new things.*
- *Life is only available once you cross your fear.*
- *Communication is a tool required to live life.*

Q2. They won't understand me:

Whether this is true or false would depend on what you do in the conversation.

They might not live up to your resolution, as you might be looking for an immediate solution/not willing to take corrective action/etc. - We need to understand that elders have a different way of looking at things, so they think differently.

What to do then: *- Put your point and understand their answers/solutions on that. If you do not agree or are not comfortable, discuss it again. Don't look for your answers only because other solutions also exist; they might be a bit far from our minds.*

What is the crux? There are short-term resolutions and long-term solutions to our problems. We shall find long-term solutions to our problems.

What does it really take to do communication?

1. ***Be Honest:*** *Clearly express your feelings without exaggeration.*
2. ***Stay Calm:*** *Take deep breaths and try to stay calm when explaining how you feel.*
3. ***Be Specific:*** *Explain exactly what is bothering you and why.*
4. ***Use I Statements:*** *Focus on your own feelings rather than blaming others (e.g., I feel… instead of You made me feel…).*
5. ***Listen:*** *Be open to the other person's perspective and listen to their response.*
6. ***Ask for What You Need:*** *Clearly state what you need or how others can help you.*

7. ***Be Patient:*** *Understand that others may need time to respond or may not immediately know how to help.*

8. ***Respect Differences:*** *Accept that others may have different viewpoints and solutions.*

<u>Some Conversations can be done as follows:</u> Examples

Conversation 1: Child with Parent

- ***Situation: Child is feeling overwhelmed with homework.***

  Child: *Mom, I feel really overwhelmed with my homework today. It's so much, and I don't know where to start.*

  Parent: *I understand; it can be tough sometimes. Can you show me what you have to do? Let's break it down into smaller tasks together.*

  Child: *Okay, I have math, science, and English assignments. I feel like I can't finish them all.*

  Parent: *Let's tackle one subject at a time. How about we start with math, spend 30 minutes on it, and then take a short break?*

  Child: *That sounds better. I think I can manage that.*

Conversation 2: Child with Teacher

- ***Situation: Child is confused about a class lesson.***

  Child: *Mam, I'm having trouble understanding today's lesson on fractions. Could you explain it to me again?*

  Teacher: *Sure, why not? Which part are you finding most confusing?*

  Child: *I don't understand how to add fractions with different denominators.*

  Teacher: *Let's go over it step by step. Remember, you need to find a common denominator first. Let's work through a problem together.*

Conversation 3: Child with Sibling

- ***Situation: Child feels left out during playtime.***

  Child: *Hey, can I talk to you for a minute? I feel like I'm being left out when you play with your friends.*

  Sibling: *I'm sorry, I didn't realize you felt that way. Why don't you join us? What do you want to play?*

  Child: *I'd like to play tag with you all. Can we do that?*

  Sibling: *Sure, I'll let everyone know. Thanks for telling me how you feel.*

Conversation 4: Child with Friend

- ***Situation: Child is feeling sad because of a disagreement with a friend.***

  Child: *Hey, can we talk? I felt really upset after our argument yesterday.*

  Friend: *Yeah, I'm sorry too. I didn't mean to hurt feelings.*

  Child: *I want us to understand each other better. I felt like you weren't listening to me.*

  Friend: *I understand. Let's make sure we both listen to each other next time. Friends?*

  Child: *Friends.*

Conversation 5: Child with Parent (Different Scenario)

- ***Situation: Child feels anxious about an upcoming test.***

  Child: *Dad, I'm really nervous about my test tomorrow. I'm afraid I might fail.*

  Parent: *It's normal to feel nervous before a test. Have you studied and prepared well?*

  Child: *I think so, but I still feel scared.*

Parent: *Let's review some of the material together. Sometimes, going over it one more time can help you feel more confident. Also, remember to take deep breaths and stay calm.*

Conversation 6: Child with Parent (Emotional Support)

- **Situation: Child feels sad and doesn't know why.**

  Child: *Mom, I feel really sad today, but I don't know why.*

  Parent: *It's okay to feel sad sometimes, even if you don't know why. Do you want to talk about anything that might be bothering you, or do you need a hug?*

  Child: *I think I need a hug.*

  Parent: *Come here. Remember, it's okay to have days like this. If you want to talk more later, I'm here for you.*

Conversation 7: Child with Teacher (Asking for Help)

- **Situation: Child needs help with a project.**

  Child: *Ma'am, I need some help with my science project.*

  I'm not sure how to start.

  Teacher: *Ok. What part are you struggling with?*

  Child: *I don't know how to formulate a hypothesis or set up the experiment.*

  Teacher: *Let's brainstorm some ideas together. First, think about what you want to investigate. Then, we'll write a hypothesis and plan your experiment.*

Conversation 8: Child with Sibling (Conflict Resolution)

- **Situation: Child and sibling fought over a toy.**

  Child: *I didn't like it when you took my toy without asking. It made me really angry.*

Sibling: *I'm sorry, I should have asked. I didn't mean to upset you.*

Child: *Can we agree to ask each other before taking toys? That would make me feel better.*

Sibling: *Yes, let's do that. I'm really sorry.*

Child: *Thanks. I appreciate it.*

Conversation 9: Child with Friend (Sharing Feelings)

- ***Situation: Child feels lonely and wants to play.***

  Child: *Hey, I've been feeling a bit lonely lately. Do you want to hang out and play something together?*

  Friend: *Sure, I'd love to. What do you want to play?*

  Child: *Maybe we can play some board games or go outside.*

  Friend: *Sounds fun! Let's do it.*

Section-8

Hero vs Superhero



Almost every movie, game, comic book, and story has a hero. Some heroes wear capes, some have magical powers, some can fly, and some can lift enormous weights. But have you ever noticed something interesting? ***The most important thing about a hero is not their powers—it is the choices they make.*** *A hero is not someone who never faces problems; a hero is someone who continues moving forward even when life becomes difficult. A hero gets scared but still takes action, makes mistakes but learns from them, and falls but gets back up again. If you think about it carefully, you do not need a cape to become a hero. Every day gives you opportunities to act like one. Every time you choose honesty over cheating, kindness over cruelty, learning over excuses, or courage over fear, you are practicing what real heroes do. The truth is that heroes are not born; they are built, one choice at a time, one challenge at a time, and one lesson at a time. And perhaps the most surprising thing is this: everyone reading this book already has the potential to become one.*

What Makes A Hero?

What differs between a normal person and a hero/superhero is the ability to knock back (which requires the right tools) with confidence (in finding a solution) and clear thinking of what is needed to win a situation. He knows his resources and arranges them in advance rather than leaving it to the situation or others to win the battle.

This section helps you analyze the situation and gather what you want to add to your kitty to make it a hero/superhero.

1. The Brave Little Seed

Theme: *Self-Confidence*

Once upon a time, in a lush green forest, a little seed lay hidden beneath the soil. Every day, it heard the tall trees whisper, "You are too small to grow like us." But the little seed believed in itself. With each passing day, it pushed through the soil, soaking in sunlight and rain. Soon, it sprouted into a beautiful flower, standing tall and proud. The trees were amazed and said, " You have proved us wrong. You are brave and strong. The little seed smiled, knowing that self-confidence had helped it bloom.

The Tools of A Hero

Lesson: *Believe in yourself, even when others doubt you. Self-confidence can help you achieve great things.*

But keep in mind:

- *This growth will take time, and till then, all will be doing what they are doing (telling you something that you may not like). It's your ingredient for success.*
- *During this period, you would have to maintain the belief that you are growing and that results will come soon.*
- *If you lose this thought and go into a fight with others, then you might lose, as you cannot fight more than a few at a time.*
- *This would need strength to keep going; you need to wait.*
- *The struggle to listen, keep growing, and stay positive is required.*

Activities:

Write yourself a confidence letter every few days.

2. Lila and the Missing Puzzle Piece

Theme: *Critical Thinking*

Lila loved solving puzzles. One day, she faced her toughest challenge yet: a 1,000-piece puzzle. As she worked, she noticed a piece was missing. Instead of getting upset, Lila used her critical thinking skills. She retraced her steps, checked under the table, and even asked her cat if it had taken the piece. Finally, she found the missing piece under the rug. With a smile, she completed the puzzle.

Lesson: *When faced with a problem, use critical thinking to find a solution. Think logically and don't give up.*

- *What we miss at this time is awareness of what is missing for the solution.*
- *We need focus and confidence to move towards a solution.*
- *This helps us look into various areas we normally miss.*
- *Emotions have to be set aside, and logical thinking is required to resolve the problem or learn something new about it.*

3. Ben's Second Thoughts

Theme: *Think again*

Ben always thought that being popular meant having the most friends. But one day, he noticed that his friends weren't very kind. He started to feel unhappy. Ben decided to think again about what friendship really meant. He realized that true friends are kind and supportive, and they make you feel good about yourself. Ben chose to spend time with friends who valued him for who he was, not for being popular.

Lesson: *It's important to re-evaluate your thoughts and beliefs. Sometimes, thinking again can lead to better decisions and a happier life.*

Story 2A:

The Adventure of Alex and the Enchanted Forest

Once upon a time in a small village, there lived a curious and kind-hearted boy named Alex. One day, he heard about an enchanted forest where a wise old owl lived. The owl was said to grant wisdom to anyone who completed a series of challenges. Alex, determined and confident, decided to embark on this adventure.

Challenge 1: The Bridge of Belief

As Alex approached the forest, he encountered a rickety old bridge. He hesitated, hearing the villagers' whispers in his mind: "You're too young to cross it." But Alex believed in himself. He took a deep breath, walked carefully, and made it to the other side.

The ***lesson*** *here was clear:*

- ***Self-confidence*** *helps you overcome obstacles.*
- *Other thoughts must be seen as the necessary steps that must be taken to avoid failure.*
- *If you don't follow your belief, you won't get anywhere and will be unhappy with your decision.*

Challenge 2: The Puzzle of the Hidden Path

Deep in the forest, Alex found himself lost. He noticed strange markings on the trees and remembered a story his grandfather told him about using clues to find hidden paths. Alex sat down, observed the markings, and used his critical thinking to decode the directions. Slowly, he figured out the way and continued his journey.

*The **lesson** here was clear:*

- *He was not tense about what he could do, nor was he thinking he could not do it.*
- *He was clear that he wanted a solution*
- *He was present in the situation and was seeing what we find difficult in that situation because we live in tension or fear.*

Challenge 3: The Garden of Choices

*Alex then arrived at a beautiful garden with two paths. One path was filled with beautiful flowers, but the other had a sign that read, "True friends are like stars; they shine brightest in darkness." Alex thought about his friendships. He had always believed that the more friends he had, the better. But he realized that true friends are those who support you in tough times. He decided to take the less beautiful, star-lit path, demonstrating his ability to **reconsider** his beliefs.*

*The **lesson** here was clear:*

He was not tense about what he could do, or was not thinking he could do it, or

Challenge 4: The Test of Truth

*As he walked, Alex found a golden apple lying on the ground. A voice echoed, Take it; it's yours. But Alex knew the apple wasn't his. He remembered his father's words about honesty and **ethics**. He decided to leave the apple and continued on his way, feeling good about making the right choice.*

*The **lesson** here was clear:*

- *Had he listened to his voice and gone against his Values, he would have opened a negative & selfish thought bag forever in his life.*
- *Had he allowed himself to do this, he might have become rich, but would have been forever busy hiding it and would*

have had to give back as well as what was not his originally.

- *He felt good only because he respected his value system; otherwise, he would have had this thought forever of going against himself.*

Challenge 5: The Politeness Pond

Finally, Alex reached a pond guarded by a talking frog. The frog asked for help to find a pebble lost in the water. Alex agreed and said," Please show me where to look. After finding the pebble, he handed it to the frog and said, thank you for letting me help. When he accidentally splashed water on the frog, he quickly apologized, I'm sorry. The frog smiled and said, " Your ***social manners*** *have granted you access to the owl.*

The ***lesson*** *here was clear:*

He was not tense about what he could do, or was not thinking he could do it, or

At last, Alex met the wise old owl, who praised him for his self-confidence, critical thinking, ability to re-evaluate his thoughts, ethical behavior, and good manners. The owl said," You have shown wisdom beyond your years, Alex. Remember these lessons, and you will lead a happy and fulfilling life.

Alex returned to his village with a heart full of lessons and a mind full of wisdom, ready to share his story with others.

Story 2B

The Journey Through the Forest of Life

One evening, just before sunset, Alex sat quietly beneath a tree, watching the sky change colors. Like many young people, he often wondered about the future. He wondered what kind of person he would become. Would he be brave when life became difficult? Would he know what to do when people disagreed with him? Would he make the right choices when

faced with challenges? The more he thought about these questions, the more confused he became.

As he sat there, an old traveler appeared on the nearby path. The traveler seemed ordinary, yet there was something peaceful about him. He noticed Alex's thoughtful expression and asked what was troubling him. Alex shared all the questions he carried in his mind. The traveler listened carefully, then handed him a small compass.

"This compass will not show you north or south," the traveler said. "Instead, it will guide you through the Forest of Life. There you will discover something much more important than directions."

Before Alex could ask another question, the traveler disappeared.

Curious and determined, Alex stepped into the forest.

At first, the journey seemed easy. The path was wide and clear. Birds sang from the trees and sunlight filtered through the leaves. But after some time, the forest became darker, and the path narrowed. Soon, Alex found himself standing before a wide valley. As he looked across it, strange voices began to echo around him.

"You are too young."

"You are not good enough."

"You will never make it."

The voices sounded so real that Alex almost turned back. For a moment, he believed them. Then he remembered something his grandmother had once told him: "Confidence is not believing that nothing will go wrong. Confidence is believing that you can keep going even when things do."

Alex took a deep breath and moved forward. With every step he took, the voices became quieter. They did not disappear

immediately, but they lost their power over him. By the time he reached the other side of the valley, Alex understood something important. Fear and doubt may always exist, but they do not have to control our choices.

As the journey continued, the compass led him into a maze filled with signs pointing in different directions. One sign promised a quick solution. Another claimed that everyone else was following its path. A third insisted it had all the answers. Alex felt tempted to follow the first sign he saw. However, he paused and looked more carefully. He examined the paths, searched for clues, and questioned what seemed obvious. Eventually, he discovered a hidden trail that led safely out of the maze. Many travelers remained lost because they followed whatever appeared easiest. Alex learned that thinking carefully and asking questions often reveal what others miss.

Later that day, he arrived at a beautiful lake. As he looked into the water, he expected to see his reflection. Instead, he saw moments from his own life. He saw times when he had compared himself to others. He saw assumptions he had made about people before truly knowing them. He saw beliefs he had accepted without questioning. Sitting beside the lake, Alex realized that not every thought deserves to be believed. Sometimes growth begins when we are willing to rethink what we assume is true.

The journey continued until he reached a crossroads. One path was wide, smooth, and attractive. The other looked difficult and uncertain. A sign explained that the easy road offered quick rewards, while the harder road required honesty, patience, courage, and responsibility. Alex stood there for a long time. He knew the easier road would be tempting. Yet he also knew that the kind of person he wanted to become could not be built through shortcuts. He chose the more difficult path. Although it demanded more effort, each step made him feel stronger inside. For the first time, he understood why

values matter. They help us make good decisions when life presents difficult choices.

As evening approached, Alex reached a large bridge. Many travelers stood there arguing. Everyone wanted to cross, but nobody was listening to one another. Some were angry. Some were frustrated. Some wanted their own way. Alex watched for a while and then remembered everything he had learned during his journey. Instead of arguing, he listened. Instead of demanding, he communicated respectfully. Gradually, others began doing the same. One by one, they worked together and crossed the bridge.

Finally, Alex arrived at the center of the forest, where a magnificent tree stretched high into the sky. Beneath it sat the old traveler.

"You have returned," the traveler said.

Alex smiled. "I found confidence, critical thinking, self-awareness, values, and communication."

The traveler shook his head gently.

"No," he replied. "You did not find them. You built them."

Alex looked down at the compass in his hand.

"It was never the compass that guided you," the traveler continued. "The compass only reminded you to trust the tools already inside you."

As Alex left the forest, he realized something important. Every person has their own forest to walk through. Everyone faces doubts, confusion, difficult decisions, misunderstandings, and challenges. The difference is not in the challenges themselves. The difference is in the tools we use to face them.

The journey was never about reaching the end of the forest.

It was about becoming the person capable of walking through it.

And that is what makes an ordinary person a hero.

Your Superhero Tool Kit

Throughout this book, you have been collecting something far more valuable than treasure, trophies, or rewards. You have been collecting tools. Just as a carpenter uses tools to build a house and an explorer carries equipment to navigate unknown lands, you, too, now possess a set of tools that can help you face life's challenges with greater confidence and wisdom.

These tools may not be visible, but they are powerful.

- ***Awareness*** *helps you notice what is happening within you and around you.*
- ***Observation*** *teaches you to pay attention before jumping to conclusions.*
- ***Self-Reflection*** *helps you learn from your experiences and understand yourself better.*
- ***Critical Thinking*** *helps you question information, examine evidence, and make thoughtful decisions.*
- ***Values*** *act as your compass, guiding you toward what is right and meaningful.*
- ***Communication*** *allows you to express your thoughts, feelings, and needs while understanding others.*
- ***Gratitude*** *reminds you to appreciate the people, opportunities, and experiences that support your journey.*
- ***Courage*** *helps you take action even when you feel uncertain or afraid.*

- ***Patience*** *reminds you that meaningful growth takes time and that great things are often built one small step at a time.*

These tools are not meant to sit on a shelf. They become stronger every time you use them. Just as muscles grow through exercise, these qualities grow through practice. The more you observe, reflect, communicate, think critically, and act in line with your values, the stronger these tools become.

You will not need every tool in every situation. Sometimes courage will help you most. Sometimes patience will be the key. At other times, communication, gratitude, or critical thinking may guide you forward. The wisdom lies in knowing which tool to use and when.

Remember, extraordinary powers do not define superheroes. They are defined by how they use the tools, strengths, and values they already possess. Throughout this book, you have been building your own superhero tool kit. It now belongs to you.

Carry it with confidence. Use it wisely. Keep adding to it throughout your life. Every challenge you face will become another opportunity to sharpen the tools that help you grow into the person you are capable of becoming.

A Letter To The Hero Reading This Book

Dear Reader,

If you have reached this page, it means you have completed a journey.

You have explored your thoughts.

You have learned about your emotions.

You have discovered the importance of values.

You have practiced critical thinking.

You have reflected on friendships, communication, gratitude, and self-awareness.

But the most important thing to remember is this:
This book was never meant to change your life.
You are the one who changes your life.
The ideas in these pages are only tools.

Like any tool, they become useful only when you choose to use them.

There will be days when you feel confident.
There will be days when you doubt yourself.
There will be successes.
There will be mistakes.
There will be moments when you know exactly what to do and moments when you feel completely lost.

That is normal.
That is life.

Remember that growth is not about becoming perfect.

Growth is about becoming a little wiser, a little kinder, and a little stronger than you were yesterday.

Keep asking questions.
Keep learning.
Keep helping others.
Keep thinking for yourself.
Keep being curious.
Most importantly, keep being you.

The world does not need another copy of someone else.
The world needs the best version of you.

Your story is still being written.
And the next chapter begins now.